

ENGLISH FOR RETAIL AND DIGITAL COMMERCE TEAMS

Retail and E-Commerce English

Explain the offer. Trace the order. Make the numbers meaningful.

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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For merchandising, digital trading, inventory, fulfillment, customer service, and store operations teams.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight commercial conversations: compare ranges, examine a promotion, locate sellable stock, explain a delivery delay, investigate checkout performance, challenge a vendor scorecard, handle a return request, and repair a pickup handoff.

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Connect the commercial claim to the customer experience

Retail teams move between units, orders, prices, stock states, and customer promises. These conversations practice making each distinction clear while keeping the next action useful.

Name the measure before the result

Revenue, gross profit, units, and conversion answer different questions. State the denominator and comparison period before drawing a conclusion.

"Units increased, but gross profit fell on the stated cost basis."

Locate the stock behind the promise

A national total does not establish availability at a pickup store. Check the item, location, inventory state, and fulfillment route.

"Thirty units are available at the warehouse; this store has none."

Make uncertainty useful

An honest delivery update combines the latest verified status with a named next step. Do not turn an estimated arrival into a guarantee.

"The carrier has not confirmed a new arrival time; I will update you at two."

Separate authority from empathy

Acknowledge the inconvenience without inventing a refund, replacement, or policy exception. Explain available review routes and applicable customer rights.

"I can submit the exception request, but I cannot approve it myself."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All companies, customers, products, figures, and local procedures are fictional. This book teaches professional English, not legal, accounting, or operational advice. Actual consumer rights, return obligations, marketplace terms, and shipping requirements depend on the transaction and jurisdiction. Store policies do not override applicable rights. Software terminology varies by platform.

Equal revenue, different stock exposure

A Read the situation

Compare product ranges using a defined sell-through measure and a balanced buying recommendation.

During the same four-week season, Range A sold 80 of its 100 opening units for \$12,000. Range B sold 120 of its 200 opening units, also for \$12,000. There were no receipts, returns, or stock adjustments. A sold at full price; B required markdowns. For this review, unit sell-through means units sold divided by opening units. Buyer Inez and planner Cal must discuss next season without assuming that equal revenue means equal performance. Product costs and customer-segment evidence are not yet available.

PEOPLE / Inez: Buyer | Cal: Merchandise planner

CHALLENGE THE MEASURE, NOT THE BUYER

A range can matter for customer choice even when its stock turns slowly. Recognize that commercial purpose, then identify the missing evidence. A precise question about margin or remaining stock is more useful than calling a colleague's selection a failure.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is Range A's sell-through under the stated definition?

- | | |
|---------------|--------------|
| A 60% | B 40% |
| C 120% | D 80% |

2. How many units remain in Range B?

- | | |
|--------------|--------------|
| A 80 | B 20 |
| C 120 | D 200 |

3. What is not yet established?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A Range B used markdowns | B Range A sold 80 units |
| C Which range has higher gross profit | D Both ranges earned \$12,000 revenue |

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

assortment

The selection of products offered to customers.

IN USE review the assortment

range

A related group of products offered for sale.

IN USE compare product ranges

stock-keeping unit (SKU)

An internal identifier for a specific stocked item or variant.

IN USE rationalize the SKU count

sell-through

Units sold as a proportion of a defined stock base.

IN USE calculate unit sell-through

opening stock

Inventory held at the start of a period.

IN USE establish opening stock

residual stock

Inventory remaining after the measured selling period.

IN USE reduce residual stock

markdown

A reduction from an earlier selling price.

IN USE take a markdown

full-price sale

A sale at the regular undiscounted price.

IN USE protect full-price sales

option count

The number of distinct product choices in a range.

IN USE review the option count

assortment breadth

The variety of categories or product choices offered.

IN USE broaden the assortment

assortment depth

The variety of options within a product category or line, distinct from units held per option.

IN USE adjust assortment depth

size curve

The planned distribution of units across sizes.

IN USE revise the size curve

Precision check

Sell-through definitions differ. This case uses units sold divided by opening units, with no other stock movements. A is 80%; B is 60%. Do not quietly substitute revenue or remaining units as the denominator.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

colorway

A particular color version of a product.

IN USE add a colorway

core line

A recurring product line central to the offer.

IN USE replenish a core line

seasonal line

A line intended for a particular selling season.

IN USE exit a seasonal line

range review

A structured assessment of the product selection.

IN USE conduct a range review

buying budget

Funds allocated to purchasing merchandise.

IN USE protect the buying budget

open-to-buy

A planned merchandise purchasing allowance after commitments.

IN USE check open-to-buy

stock turn

A measure of how frequently inventory is sold or replaced.

IN USE compare stock turn

weeks of cover

Stock expressed in weeks at a specified sales rate.

IN USE assess weeks of cover

gross margin return on inventory

Gross profit relative to average inventory cost.

IN USE evaluate inventory return

delist

Remove an item from the active product selection.

IN USE propose a delisting

range rationalization

Simplifying the assortment using stated commercial criteria.

IN USE support range rationalization

customer segment

A group of customers with relevant shared characteristics.

IN USE serve a customer segment

Precision check

Equal sales revenue does not establish equal gross profit or inventory return. Costs, timing, stock investment, and the role of each range matter. A recommendation can identify further analysis without pretending the final buying decision is settled.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN THE COMPARISON

"Both ranges generated \$12,000 in the same four weeks."

STATE THE STRONGER RATE

"Range A sold through at eighty percent."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE COMMERCIAL ROLE

"B may serve a different customer segment."

IDENTIFY THE PRICE EFFECT

"B reached the same revenue with markdowns."

DEFINE THE MEASURE

"Here, sell-through uses units sold divided by opening stock."

STATE THE REMAINING EXPOSURE

"Range B still has eighty units on hand."

SEPARATE UNITS AND REVENUE

"More units sold does not necessarily mean more revenue."

ASK FOR THE MISSING BASIS

"Can we add product costs before comparing gross profit?"

At full price

Describes the transaction price, not automatically a higher profit.

Sold through at

Introduces a rate with an explicitly defined stock base.

Subject to

Makes the recommendation conditional on named evidence.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID AN AUTOMATIC DECISION

"This is not enough evidence to delist the whole range."

PROTECT A USEFUL DISTINCTION

"The rate is lower even though unit sales are higher."

LIMIT THE RECOMMENDATION

"I recommend a more targeted buy, subject to the missing evidence."

PRESERVE THE CUSTOMER QUESTION

"We still need to understand which customers bought B."

NARROW THE NEXT REVIEW

"Let us examine B by size and colorway."

REQUEST COMPARABLE PERIODS

"Keep both ranges on the same four-week basis."

CLARIFY COMMITMENT

"A proposal is not a released purchase order."

SUMMARIZE THE TRADE-OFF

"The same revenue came with different stock and price exposure."

Even though

Connects a higher unit count with a lower sell-through rate.

By size and colorway

Narrows analysis to commercially useful product variants.

Not enough evidence

Challenges the conclusion without dismissing the data.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which comparison is accurate?

- A** A sold 80% of opening units; B sold 60%.
- B** A sold fewer units, so its sell-through must be lower.
- C** Both sell-through rates are equal because revenue is equal.
- D** B sold 120%, using A's opening stock.

2. Which claim needs product costs?

- A** B required markdowns.
- B** A earned more gross profit than B.
- C** B sold 120 units.
- D** A had 20 units remaining.

3. Which recommendation is appropriately limited?

- A** Double B solely because it sold more units.
- B** Treat equal revenue as proof of equal inventory return.
- C** Review B by variant and customer segment before changing the buy.
- D** Delist every B item because one period proves no demand.

4. Which wording states a condition?

- A** The review guarantees higher future sales.
- B** We can revise the buy once the cost and variant review is complete.
- C** We have already released the order.
- D** Every missing cost is zero.

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

Equal revenue, different stock exposure

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

markdown / residual stock / sell-through / size curve / range review / delisting / buying budget / assortment depth / gross margin return on inventory / customer segment

- 01 **Inez:** Both ranges brought in twelve thousand. Can we repeat the buy? B needed more promotional support, but I do not want to cut a range customers still use.
- 02 **Cal:** Before we repeat the buy, look at ¹ _____. A sold eighty of one hundred units; B sold one hundred twenty of two hundred. That gives eighty percent and sixty percent respectively.
- 03 **Inez:** B did sell forty more units. I do not want the team to lose sight of that demand when we review the range.
- 04 **Cal:** Agreed, but B also leaves more ² _____. We have eighty units remaining there, compared with twenty in A. Those units still need a commercial plan.
- 05 **Inez:** We reached the same revenue through different prices. A held its regular price, while B required reductions during the season.
- 06 **Cal:** Exactly. The ³ _____ helped B move units, but we cannot judge the profit effect properly without product costs. The revenue line alone will not settle that question.
- 07 **Inez:** Should we remove B completely? That would release buying budget, but it might also leave a gap for a customer group we serve.
- 08 **Cal:** I would not recommend an immediate ⁴ _____. First, separate B by size and colorway. An aggregate result can hide strong variants alongside weak ones.
- 09 **Inez:** Some sizes may be carrying the leftovers. We should see whether the original distribution matched what customers actually selected.
- 10 **Cal:** Then review the ⁵ _____. That may support changing quantities within the range rather than removing every option. We need the variant-level data before deciding.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Inez:** I also want to know whether B attracts customers who rarely buy A. Equal revenue does not tell us whether the ranges overlap.
- 12 **Cal:** Yes, include the ⁶ _____ evidence. We should not describe B as unnecessary until we understand its role. That is a separate question from this period's lower rate.
- 13 **Inez:** Could we call for a smaller initial order, with more room to react later?
- 14 **Cal:** We can propose that within the ⁷ _____, but supplier lead times and minimum quantities still need checking. Flexibility on paper is not always available in the supply arrangement.
- 15 **Inez:** Let us keep the recommendation conditional and show the remaining inventory separately.
- 16 **Cal:** I will add ⁸ _____ once we have the required cost and average-stock information. I will not manufacture it from these sales totals.
- 17 **Inez:** Good. Keep the four-week dates visible so we do not compare a full season with a partial one.
- 18 **Cal:** The ⁹ _____ will show common dates, both denominators, the price reductions, and the outstanding analysis. That makes the recommendation easier to challenge constructively.
- 19 **Inez:** Hold the repeat order, then. Bring me the size and color breakdown with costs before we decide which options to keep.
- 20 **Cal:** Correct. We can revisit ¹⁰ _____ after that review, alongside quantities per option. Equal revenue is the starting observation, not the final buying decision.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. sell-through | 2. residual stock | 3. markdown | 4. delisting | 5. size curve | 6. customer segment | 7. buying budget | 8. gross margin return on inventory | 9. range review | 10. assortment depth

Compare a second pair of ranges

F Say it

Range C sells 45 of 60 opening units. Range D sells 60 of 120 opening units. There are no other stock movements. Use the same unit sell-through definition.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

60 / 75% / 50% / 15

Buyer: "C has a sell-through rate of ¹ _____."

Planner: "D has a sell-through rate of ² _____."

Buyer: "C has ³ _____ units remaining."

Planner: "D has ⁴ _____ units remaining."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. 75% | 2. 50% | 3. 15 | 4. 60

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10; contrast units sold, sell-through, and remaining stock.
2. Swap roles for turns 11-20; keep the next buy conditional on the cost and variant review.
3. Complete the transfer and check each range against its own opening stock.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit

A Read the situation

Explain price-volume arithmetic and challenge a profit claim without dismissing the promotion goal.

In the baseline week, a product sold 100 units at \$50 each. During the promotion it sold 120 units at \$42.50 each, a 15% price reduction. Product cost remained \$30 per unit. These are complete comparable weekly sales with no returns. Taxes, shipping income, operating expenses, and other promotional costs are excluded. Trading manager Hugo says the 20% unit increase proves that profit improved. Finance partner Nia must correct that claim and separate the measured result from other possible campaign objectives.

PEOPLE / Hugo: Trading manager | Nia: Finance partner

KEEP THE SUCCESS CRITERION EXPLICIT

A promotional team may emphasize traffic or new customers while finance emphasizes margin. Name the objective being tested. Correcting the arithmetic does not require calling the entire campaign a failure; other benefits need their own evidence.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What was promotion revenue?

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| A \$5,100 | B \$6,000 |
| C \$4,250 | D \$5,000 |

2. What was promotion gross profit on the stated basis?

- | | |
|------------------|------------------|
| A \$2,400 | B \$5,100 |
| C \$1,500 | D \$2,000 |

3. Which cost is excluded?

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| A The \$30 unit product cost | B Cost of all 120 units sold |
| C Cost of baseline units sold | D Operating expenses |

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

selling price

The amount charged per unit before specified adjustments.

IN USE set the selling price

unit volume

The number of units sold during a period.

IN USE increase unit volume

sales revenue

Income from the measured sales before the stated costs.

IN USE calculate sales revenue

cost of goods sold

Product costs attributable to the units sold.

IN USE deduct cost of goods sold

gross profit

Sales revenue less cost of goods sold.

IN USE protect gross profit

gross margin percentage

Gross profit divided by sales revenue, expressed as a percentage.

IN USE calculate gross margin percentage

price reduction

A decrease in the selling price.

IN USE apply a price reduction

promotional uplift

An increase against a defined nonpromotional comparison.

IN USE measure promotional uplift

baseline

The reference level used for comparison.

IN USE establish a baseline

incremental revenue

Additional revenue relative to the defined comparison.

IN USE estimate incremental revenue

unit gross profit

Selling price less the stated product cost per unit.

IN USE compare unit gross profit

contribution margin

Revenue less the variable costs included in its definition.

IN USE define contribution margin

Precision check

Units rose 20%, while price fell 15%. Revenue changes multiplicatively: 1.20 times 0.85 equals 1.02, a 2% increase. Subtracting the two percentages would incorrectly give 5%.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

price elasticity

The responsiveness of quantity demanded to price changes.

IN USE estimate price elasticity

cannibalization

Sales gained by one offer at another offer's expense.

IN USE assess cannibalization

halo effect

A related benefit beyond the promoted product itself.

IN USE test for a halo effect

basket value

The monetary value of a customer's purchase basket.

IN USE increase basket value

average order value

Revenue divided by the relevant order count.

IN USE monitor average order value

discount depth

The size of a price reduction against its reference.

IN USE compare discount depth

redemption rate

The proportion using an offer among a defined eligible base.

IN USE calculate redemption rate

promotion mechanic

The structure by which an offer operates.

IN USE explain the promotion mechanic

funding allowance

A contribution toward promotion costs under agreed terms.

IN USE verify a funding allowance

price override

An authorized change from the system's listed selling price.

IN USE approve a price override

break-even volume

Units required to meet a specified cost or profit threshold.

IN USE calculate break-even volume

margin dilution

A reduction in the relevant profit margin.

IN USE quantify margin dilution

Precision check

Baseline gross profit is \$2,000; promotion gross profit is \$1,500, down 25%. This is not net profit. Gross margin percentage falls from 40% to approximately 29.4% under the stated cost exclusions.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE VOLUME

"The promotion sold twenty percent more units."

STATE THE NEW PRICE

"The promotional price was \$42.50."

CALCULATE REVENUE

"One hundred twenty times \$42.50 gives \$5,100."

SHOW THE UNIT EFFECT

"Unit gross profit fell from twenty dollars to \$12.50."

CORRECT THE INFERENCE

"That does not by itself establish higher profit."

KEEP THE COST BASIS

"Product cost stayed at thirty dollars per unit."

SEPARATE THE MEASURES

"Revenue rose two percent; gross profit fell twenty-five percent."

NAME THE EXCLUSION

"This calculation excludes operating and promotional expenses."

By itself

Restricts what one measure can prove.

From ... to ...

Makes the original and new values explicit.

Excludes

Names costs or revenues outside the calculation.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

DEFINE THE MARGIN

"Gross margin percentage uses revenue as its denominator."

RECOGNIZE ANOTHER OBJECTIVE

"New-customer acquisition would need a separate measure."

LIMIT THE CONCLUSION

"These figures do not establish net profitability."

PROTECT THE BASELINE

"Use the same product and comparable periods."

AVOID A FALSE SHORTCUT

"The price and volume changes must be multiplied."

ASK ABOUT FUNDING

"Has any supplier allowance actually been agreed?"

EXPLAIN THE THRESHOLD

"At \$12.50 per unit, 160 units would match the prior gross profit."

CLOSE THE REVIEW

"Let us report the volume gain and the margin cost together."

Approximately

Marks a rounded percentage, not an exact value.

Would match

States a conditional threshold, not an achieved result.

Actually agreed

Distinguishes confirmed funding from hoped-for support.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which statement correctly combines the price and volume effects?

- A** Revenue rose 20%.
- B** Revenue fell 15%.
- C** Revenue rose 2%.
- D** Revenue rose 5%.

2. What happened to gross profit?

- A** It increased to \$5,100.
- B** It stayed at \$2,000.
- C** It increased 20% with units.
- D** It fell from \$2,000 to \$1,500.

3. How many promotional units would match baseline gross profit?

- A** 100
- B** 120
- C** 150
- D** 160

4. Which claim goes beyond the supplied evidence?

- A** Product cost remained \$30 per unit.
- B** Promotion revenue was \$5,100.
- C** Gross profit fell on the stated basis.
- D** The campaign acquired profitable new customers.

Answers and explanations: [page 87](#).

A busy promotion with a smaller gross profit

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

gross margin percentage / unit volume / gross profit / funding allowance / margin dilution / break-even volume / unit gross profit / Sales revenue / cost of goods sold / baseline

- 01 **Hugo:** Units were up twenty percent. I have called that a profit improvement in the trading note. Can you check the wording before I send it?
- 02 **Nia:** The ¹ _____ improved, but the price fell. Let us calculate the money result before choosing that wording. We sold one hundred twenty units at forty-two dollars fifty.
- 03 **Hugo:** That gives five thousand one hundred dollars, compared with five thousand in the normal week.
- 04 **Nia:** Correct. ² _____ increased two percent. We multiply the quantity and price factors, rather than subtracting fifteen percent from twenty percent and calling the difference five.
- 05 **Hugo:** Revenue is still higher. Why would that not support the profit claim?
- 06 **Nia:** Because ³ _____ also increased with the extra units. At thirty dollars per unit, it was three thousand dollars before and three thousand six hundred during the promotion.
- 07 **Hugo:** So we subtract those product costs from the revenue in each week.
- 08 **Nia:** Yes. That gives ⁴ _____ of two thousand dollars before and fifteen hundred during the promotion. On that measure, the result fell twenty-five percent despite the higher revenue.
- 09 **Hugo:** We should also explain why each sale contributed less before the other costs.
- 10 **Nia:** The ⁵ _____ fell from twenty dollars to twelve dollars fifty. We would need one hundred sixty promotional units to match the previous two thousand dollars.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Hugo:** We sold only one hundred twenty, so we did not reach that threshold.
- 12 **Nia:** Right. This ⁶ _____ is defined as matching the prior gross profit, not covering every business expense. The definition needs to stay next to the number.
- 13 **Hugo:** Could traffic or new customers still make the promotion worthwhile?
- 14 **Nia:** Possibly, but those goals need evidence beyond this ⁷ _____ comparison. We have no new-customer or repeat-purchase data here. A possible benefit should not be presented as a measured result.
- 15 **Hugo:** The buyer mentioned possible supplier funding. Do we have an agreed amount, or should I leave it out of this result?
- 16 **Nia:** Only if the ⁸ _____ is confirmed and accounted for on the correct basis. At present, these figures contain no agreed supplier contribution. Keep that possibility separate.
- 17 **Hugo:** What percentage should the margin line show?
- 18 **Nia:** The ⁹ _____ is approximately twenty-nine point four percent, down from forty. That is a revenue-based ratio, not the twenty-five-percent change in gross profit dollars.
- 19 **Hugo:** I will report the volume gain and the lower gross profit, then list customer acquisition as an unanswered question.
- 20 **Nia:** Good. Describe the ¹⁰ _____ clearly without declaring every campaign objective a failure. We can assess the wider decision when the additional evidence is available.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. unit volume | 2. Sales revenue | 3. cost of goods sold | 4. gross profit | 5. unit gross profit | 6. break-even volume | 7. baseline | 8. funding allowance | 9. gross margin percentage | 10. margin dilution

Calculate another promotion result

F Say it

A product sells 50 units at \$80 in the baseline period and 60 units at \$70 in the promotion. Product cost is \$50 per unit. Exclude all other costs and returns.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

4,200 / 4,000 / 1,500 / 1,200

Manager: "Baseline revenue was ¹ _____ dollars."

Analyst: "Promotion revenue was ² _____ dollars."

Manager: "Baseline gross profit was ³ _____ dollars."

Analyst: "Promotion gross profit was ⁴ _____ dollars."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. 4,000 | 2. 4,200 | 3. 1,500 | 4. 1,200

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10; say both revenue and gross profit before assessing the promotion.
2. Swap roles for turns 11-20; distinguish the profit-matching threshold from actual sales.
3. Complete the transfer using price times units, then subtract the stated product costs.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The national total cannot promise store pickup

A Read the situation

Translate inventory states into an accurate location-specific availability message.

At 09:00, SKU L42 has 100 units physically on hand at the central warehouse: 60 committed to existing orders, ten held for quality review, and 30 available for new sales. Twenty additional units are incoming and are not included in on-hand stock. Store East has no units. The website incorrectly uses the warehouse total to display pickup availability at Store East. Inventory controller Miro and digital trader Anika must correct the promise and check delivery eligibility before offering a warehouse fulfillment route.

PEOPLE / Miro: Inventory controller | Anika: Digital trader

ASK WHICH STOCK NUMBER THE TEAM MEANS

Merchandising, stores, and digital teams may all say available while referring to different records. Repeat the location and status instead of assuming agreement. This makes a correction collaborative and prevents a national total from becoming an unsupported local promise.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many warehouse units are available for new sales?

- | | |
|-------------|--------------|
| A 30 | B 100 |
| C 60 | D 120 |

2. How many incoming units are included in the on-hand total?

- | | |
|--------------|---------------|
| A 20 | B 30 |
| C 100 | D None |

3. What is established for Store East?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Its replenishment has already arrived. | B It has no units. |
| C It has all 100 warehouse units. | D It can offer immediate pickup of 30 units. |

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

on-hand inventory

Stock physically held at the stated location.

IN USE reconcile on-hand inventory

available inventory

Stock eligible for new sales under the stated rules.

IN USE confirm available inventory

committed inventory

Stock already allocated to existing demand.

IN USE protect committed inventory

unavailable inventory

Held stock not currently eligible for sale.

IN USE classify unavailable inventory

incoming inventory

Stock expected but not yet received into the location.

IN USE track incoming inventory

quality hold

A restriction pending the applicable product-quality review.

IN USE maintain a quality hold

allocation

Assignment of stock to a demand source or destination.

IN USE revise the allocation

replenishment

Restocking to support future sales or demand.

IN USE schedule replenishment

available to promise

Quantity that can be committed under defined fulfillment rules.

IN USE calculate available to promise

stockout

Lack of the required sellable stock at a location.

IN USE report a store stockout

location-level availability

Sellable stock information for a particular site.

IN USE verify location-level availability

inventory feed

Data supplied to another system about stock quantities or states.

IN USE correct the inventory feed

Precision check

On hand is not the same as available. Here the 100 warehouse units comprise 60 committed, ten held, and 30 available. The 20 incoming units are additional expected stock, not stock already received.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

safety stock

Stock held as a buffer against uncertainty.

IN USE review safety stock

reorder point

The stock position that triggers replenishment under a policy.

IN USE set a reorder point

lead time

Elapsed time between defined order and supply milestones.

IN USE verify replenishment lead time

transfer order

A record authorizing movement between inventory locations.

IN USE create a transfer order

cycle count

A targeted physical count of selected inventory.

IN USE perform a cycle count

inventory adjustment

A recorded change to the system's stock quantity.

IN USE authorize an inventory adjustment

overselling

Accepting demand beyond what can be fulfilled as promised.

IN USE prevent overselling

backorder

Unfilled demand awaiting stock under the applicable arrangement.

IN USE manage a backorder

fulfillment eligibility

Whether an item and location may serve a specified order.

IN USE check fulfillment eligibility

stock reservation

Holding specified stock for a defined demand.

IN USE confirm a stock reservation

inventory snapshot

Quantities and states captured at a particular time.

IN USE timestamp the inventory snapshot

channel allocation

Assignment of inventory to particular sales channels.

IN USE review channel allocation

Precision check

Warehouse availability does not establish store pickup or a delivery promise. Check location, item, eligibility, reservation, and timing under the actual process. An inventory snapshot can become stale as orders and stock movements occur.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

IDENTIFY THE ITEM

"We are checking SKU L42."

SEPARATE PHYSICAL AND SELLABLE STOCK

"One hundred units are on hand, but only thirty are available."

RESPECT THE HOLD

"Ten units remain under quality review."

STATE THE LOCAL POSITION

"Store East currently has no units."

TIMESTAMP THE QUANTITY

"This is the inventory position at 09:00."

PROTECT EXISTING ORDERS

"Sixty units are already committed."

KEEP INCOMING STOCK SEPARATE

"Twenty units are incoming, not yet received."

CORRECT THE PROMISE

"The warehouse total must not drive a ready-for-pickup message here."

At 09:00

Fixes the time scope of a changing quantity.

Already committed

Protects demand that has an existing allocation.

Not yet received

Distinguishes incoming units from physically held stock.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

CHECK THE ROUTE

"Can this warehouse fulfill this customer's delivery address?"

REQUEST A FRESH CHECK

"Refresh the quantity before making the offer."

KEEP THE HOLD INTACT

"Do not release held units just to cover the website promise."

COORDINATE THE CORRECTION

"Update the customer-facing message and the underlying feed."

AVOID AN ASSUMED RESERVATION

"Availability alone does not mean this order has reserved stock."

NAME THE SYSTEM ISSUE

"The feed is using the wrong location and inventory state."

LIMIT A TRANSFER CLAIM

"A proposed transfer is not a received replenishment."

CLOSE WITH A VERIFIED OPTION

"Offer a delivery route only after eligibility is confirmed."

Currently

Signals a present position, not a permanent stockout.

Only after

Makes the offer conditional on the relevant check.

Underlying feed

Names the data source, not merely the visible message.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which website claim is supported now?

- A** Held stock is available whenever demand is high.
- B** Store East has no stock for pickup.
- C** One hundred units are ready at Store East.
- D** All incoming units are ready for immediate sale.

2. Which arithmetic matches warehouse availability?

- A** 100 minus 10 equals 90 available.
- B** 100 minus 60 equals 40 available.
- C** 100 minus 60 minus 10 equals 30.
- D** 100 plus 20 equals 120 available.

3. Which step requires a separate check?

- A** Whether twenty units are incoming
- B** Whether the warehouse can fulfill the customer's delivery route
- C** Whether Store East currently has zero units
- D** Whether ten units are held

4. Which wording overstates a proposed transfer?

- A** A transfer needs the actual timing confirmed.
- B** The replenishment has arrived at Store East.
- C** We can review a transfer option.
- D** Store East has no units at this snapshot.

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The national total cannot promise store pickup

03

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

location-level availability / committed inventory / incoming inventory / quality hold / fulfillment eligibility / transfer order / inventory snapshot / stock reservation / on-hand inventory / inventory feed

- 01 **Anika:** East is getting pickup requests for L42, but the manager says the shelf is empty. The page shows one hundred units. Can we trace where that number came from?
- 02 **Miro:** Start with the ¹ _____ at nine this morning. The hundred units belong to the central warehouse, not Store East. The page is drawing the wrong conclusion from that total.
- 03 **Anika:** Even at the warehouse, can we sell all one hundred to new customers?
- 04 **Miro:** No. That is ² _____. Sixty are committed to existing orders, and ten are held for quality review. Only thirty remain available for new sales.
- 05 **Anika:** We also have twenty on the way. Someone added them to the website quantity.
- 06 **Miro:** Keep ³ _____ separate. Those twenty have not been received. Adding them to current sellable stock would create a promise we cannot support from this snapshot.
- 07 **Anika:** Could we use the ten held units until the next shipment arrives?
- 08 **Miro:** The ⁴ _____ remains in place. We cannot release them merely because the page overpromised. The correction must respect the actual stock states rather than make them fit the message.
- 09 **Anika:** And the sixty already assigned cannot be offered a second time.
- 10 **Miro:** Correct. Protect ⁵ _____. We should not solve one customer promise by quietly taking stock from another order. The available balance here is thirty, not ninety or one hundred.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Anika:** I will remove the Store East pickup claim. Could we offer delivery from the warehouse instead?
- 12 **Miro:** First check ⁶ _____. Available stock does not prove that this warehouse serves the customer's address or that the order meets the route's conditions.
- 13 **Anika:** If delivery is possible, can I say we have put one aside? I have not created a reservation yet.
- 14 **Miro:** Only after the actual ⁷ _____ is confirmed. Other orders may arrive after our snapshot. Refresh the quantity before offering a specific commitment.
- 15 **Anika:** That handles this customer. We also need to stop the same error on other product pages.
- 16 **Miro:** Review the ⁸ _____. It needs the correct location and state, not just a national physical total. Otherwise the visible correction will be overwritten by the next update.
- 17 **Anika:** The store manager has asked for a warehouse transfer. Can we mark the store replenished?
- 18 **Miro:** Not yet. A ⁹ _____ is different from receipt. Check approval and timing, then update the store position when the relevant events actually occur.
- 19 **Anika:** I will show no pickup stock at East, check the warehouse delivery route, and raise the feed correction.
- 20 **Miro:** Good. Keep ¹⁰ _____ visible in the handoff. That gives stores, digital trading, and customer service one accurate basis for the next conversation.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. inventory snapshot | 2. on-hand inventory | 3. incoming inventory | 4. quality hold | 5. committed inventory | 6. fulfillment eligibility | 7. stock reservation | 8. inventory feed | 9. transfer order | 10. location-level availability

Read a second inventory snapshot

F Say it

At Warehouse North, 80 units are on hand: 45 committed, five held, and the rest available. Twelve more are incoming. Store South has zero units.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

twelve / five / 30 / zero

Trader: "The available warehouse quantity is ¹ _____."

Controller: "The held quantity is ² _____."

Trader: "The incoming quantity is ³ _____."

Controller: "Store South's current quantity is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. 30 | 2. five | 3. twelve | 4. zero

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10; separate on-hand, committed, held, and incoming quantities.
2. Swap roles for turns 11-20; check delivery eligibility before offering warehouse stock.
3. Complete the transfer without adding incoming units to available stock.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

An expired estimate needs an honest next step

04

A Read the situation

Acknowledge a missed delivery estimate, distinguish shipment from arrival, and explain a concrete follow-up.

Order R81 was physically handed to the carrier on 4 May. The customer was given an estimated arrival date of 6 May. It is now 7 May, and the carrier has not confirmed a new arrival time. Customer Laila needs the item for an event. Agent Tomas can open a carrier inquiry and give a status update at 14:00 today. No replacement dispatch, refund, or revised arrival is authorized in the supplied record. The team must check applicable customer rights and service remedies rather than invent a universal rule.

PEOPLE / Laila: Customer | Tomas: Customer service agent

OWN THE COMMUNICATION WITHOUT INVENTING CONTROL

Customers need an accountable seller contact even when a carrier holds the parcel. Avoid blaming another company or offering vague reassurance. State the verified event, the unanswered question, and a follow-up you can actually deliver.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is confirmed?

A The carrier physically received the order on 4 May.

C A replacement has shipped.

B The order arrived on 6 May.

D A refund is approved.

2. What does 14:00 today represent?

A A replacement dispatch time

C A status update

B An automatic refund deadline

D Guaranteed delivery

3. What is unknown?

A The order reference

C The date of carrier handoff

B The original estimated date

D The revised arrival time

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

fulfillment

The process of preparing and completing an order's supply.

IN USE track order fulfillment

dispatch

Sending goods from the seller's fulfillment operation.

IN USE confirm dispatch

carrier handoff

Physical transfer of a parcel to the transport provider.

IN USE verify carrier handoff

estimated delivery date

A projected arrival date rather than an unconditional guarantee.

IN USE revise an estimated delivery date

tracking event

A recorded milestone in a shipment's movement.

IN USE check the latest tracking event

carrier inquiry

A request for the transport provider to investigate a shipment.

IN USE open a carrier inquiry

proof of delivery

A record supporting that delivery occurred.

IN USE request proof of delivery

delivery exception

An event interrupting the expected delivery process.

IN USE investigate a delivery exception

last mile

The final transport stage to the recipient.

IN USE coordinate last-mile delivery

delivery window

A stated interval during which arrival is expected or scheduled.

IN USE confirm the delivery window

service level

The defined standard or terms of a delivery service.

IN USE verify the service level

consignment

Goods sent together under a transport arrangement.

IN USE identify the consignment

Precision check

A shipping label alone does not prove carrier possession. This case does establish physical handoff. Shipment on 4 May still does not establish delivery on 6 May or any revised arrival time.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

tracking number

An identifier used to follow a shipment.

IN USE provide the tracking number

split shipment

An order sent in separate deliveries.

IN USE explain a split shipment

partial fulfillment

Supply of only part of an order.

IN USE record partial fulfillment

delivery attempt

An effort to deliver at the specified address.

IN USE verify a delivery attempt

return to sender

Routing a parcel back to the sending party.

IN USE investigate return to sender

replacement order

An order created to supply a substitute for an earlier item.

IN USE authorize a replacement order

refund authorization

Approval to return the relevant payment.

IN USE confirm refund authorization

service recovery

Actions addressing a failure in the customer experience.

IN USE coordinate service recovery

return authorization

Permission or reference for a return under a process.

IN USE issue a return authorization

reverse logistics

Movement and handling of goods back from customers.

IN USE manage reverse logistics

return inspection

Examination of returned goods under the applicable process.

IN USE complete a return inspection

restocking fee

A charge associated with a return where applicable and lawful.

IN USE explain a restocking fee

Precision check

An update promise must not become an arrival promise. Applicable shipment-delay obligations, in-transit remedies, and return rights require the actual transaction and jurisdiction; do not treat every delay as the same legal event.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE MISSED ESTIMATE

"The estimated date has passed, and you still do not have the order."

STATE THE VERIFIED MILESTONE

"The carrier physically received the parcel on 4 May."

TAKE THE NEXT ACTION

"I can open an inquiry with the carrier now."

SEPARATE CONTACT AND ARRIVAL

"That is the update time, not a delivery guarantee."

RECOGNIZE THE IMPACT

"I understand that you need the item for an event."

AVOID AN UNSUPPORTED DATE

"I do not have a confirmed revised arrival time."

OWN THE FOLLOW-UP

"I will update you today at 14:00."

CHECK THE LATEST EVENT

"I will confirm what the tracking record actually shows."

Physically received

Distinguishes possession from a label being generated.

Estimated

Marks the stated arrival as a forecast, without erasing relevant obligations.

I do not have

Identifies the present information gap directly.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID BLAME

"I will remain your contact while we investigate."

CHECK AVAILABLE OPTIONS

"I will review the applicable service remedies and customer rights."

AVOID FALSE CERTAINTY

"The absence of a new scan does not prove the parcel is lost."

PROVIDE AN HONEST UPDATE

"I will contact you even if the carrier has not answered."

LIMIT THE REMEDY CLAIM

"No replacement has been authorized in this record."

CONFIRM BEFORE PROMISING

"I need confirmation before giving a new arrival window."

KEEP THE ORDER REFERENCE

"I will record the inquiry against R81."

CLOSE WITH ACCOUNTABILITY

"The next message will state the latest position and outstanding action."

Even if

Keeps the communication commitment valid while an answer is pending.

No ... authorized

States the record's limits without deciding all possible remedies.

Remain your contact

Maintains customer-facing ownership across another party's investigation.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response is both honest and useful?

- A** The carrier has no confirmed new arrival; I will investigate and update you at 14:00.
- B** It will certainly arrive by 14:00.
- C** The carrier has it, so the seller has no further role.
- D** No scan proves it is permanently lost.

2. Which event proves shipment in this case?

- A** Creating a label
- B** An expected arrival on 6 May
- C** Promising an update on 7 May
- D** Physical carrier handoff on 4 May

3. Which promise is not supported?

- A** A replacement will arrive tomorrow.
- B** An inquiry can be opened.
- C** An update will be given today.
- D** The revised arrival is unconfirmed.

4. What should a pending-carrier update do?

- A** Invent a new date to sound decisive.
- B** Say the customer has no rights because the date was estimated.
- C** Avoid contacting the customer until delivery occurs.
- D** State that the reply is pending and identify the continuing action.

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

An expired estimate needs an honest next step

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

delivery exception / carrier handoff / carrier inquiry / delivery window / replacement order / service recovery / estimated delivery date / tracking event / refund authorization / dispatch

- 01 **Laila:** My order was due yesterday. I need it for an event, and the tracking has stopped changing. Can you tell me whether the carrier actually has it?
- 02 **Tomas:** I am sorry the ¹ _____ has passed without the order reaching you. I can see R81, and I will check the actual shipment events rather than repeat the old date.
- 03 **Laila:** Does the record show that you sent it, or only that someone printed a label?
- 04 **Tomas:** It confirms ² _____ on the fourth of May. That is stronger than a label-created message, but it does not tell us when the parcel will reach your address.
- 05 **Laila:** The delivery was meant to be the sixth. Can you promise tomorrow instead?
- 06 **Tomas:** I cannot confirm a new ³ _____ yet. The carrier has not supplied one. I would rather give you a verified update than another date that might cause you to make unreliable plans.
- 07 **Laila:** What can you do now? I do not want to be told simply to keep refreshing the website.
- 08 **Tomas:** I can open a ⁴ _____ and remain your contact. I will ask for the current location and the latest delivery position, then update you today at fourteen hundred.
- 09 **Laila:** Do you mean the order will arrive by two, or that you will contact me then?
- 10 **Tomas:** I mean I will contact you. The latest ⁵ _____ may help explain the delay, but the update appointment is not an arrival promise. I will make that distinction clear in the note.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Laila:** Could you send another one now so that I have a backup?
- 12 **Tomas:** A ⁶ _____ has not been authorized. I can review the available remedies under the actual order and service terms, including any applicable customer rights, before confirming an option.
- 13 **Laila:** I would also like to know whether a refund is possible if the item cannot meet my need.
- 14 **Tomas:** I will check that rather than invent a ⁷ _____. The answer depends on the relevant facts and rights. I will record your event requirement so the review addresses the problem you actually face.
- 15 **Laila:** The missing scans worry me. Does that mean the parcel is lost?
- 16 **Tomas:** Not by itself. A ⁸ _____ or a delayed update needs investigation. I do not have evidence that establishes loss, and I will not label the shipment delivered without support either.
- 17 **Laila:** Please still call at two if you have not heard back. I need time to arrange something else for the event.
- 18 **Tomas:** I will. The ⁹ _____ note will include your concern, the inquiry, and the outstanding answer. You should not have to start the explanation again with another agent.
- 19 **Laila:** Thank you. I need a clear position so I can decide what to do about the event.
- 20 **Tomas:** Understood. We will keep the verified ¹⁰ _____ information separate from arrival and remedy decisions. My next contact is today at two, with the actual position even if some questions remain open.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. estimated delivery date | 2. carrier handoff | 3. delivery window | 4. carrier inquiry | 5. tracking event | 6. replacement order | 7. refund authorization | 8. delivery exception | 9. service recovery | 10. dispatch

Give a second delayed-order update

F Say it

Order V32 was handed to the carrier on 12 June. Its estimated arrival was 14 June. Today is 15 June. A new arrival time is unconfirmed; the agent will update the customer at 16:00.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

16:00 / 14 June / unconfirmed / 12 June

Agent: "Carrier handoff occurred on ¹ _____."

Customer: "The original estimated arrival was ² _____."

Agent: "The revised arrival time remains ³ _____."

Customer: "The next status update is at ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. 12 June | 2. 14 June | 3. unconfirmed | 4. 16:00

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10; distinguish carrier handoff, estimated arrival, and the update time.
2. Swap roles for turns 11-20; offer a review of real remedies without guessing the outcome.
3. Complete the transfer and identify which date is an update rather than an arrival.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A checkout decline with two competing explanations

A Read the situation

Report a conversion change accurately and distinguish an observed association from a causal claim.

Before a checkout redesign, 400 of 1,000 eligible checkout sessions completed a purchase. Afterward, 320 of 1,000 did so. For this report, checkout conversion is completed purchasing sessions divided by eligible checkout sessions; one session counts at most once. A payment-provider outage also occurred in the later period. Event collection and traffic mix have not yet been verified as comparable. Product lead Mara and analyst Dev must explain the decline without claiming that the redesign alone caused it.

PEOPLE / Mara: Digital product lead | Dev: Commerce analyst

MAKE A CHALLENGE TESTABLE

A design review can become personal when an unfavorable metric is treated as a verdict on the team. State the measured change, identify competing explanations, and request checks that can distinguish them. Avoid using uncertainty to dismiss a real decline.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the later conversion rate?

- A 40%
- C 20%

- B 8%
- D 32%

2. What is the absolute rate decline?

- A Eight percent relative
- C Thirty-two percentage points

- B Twenty percentage points
- D Eight percentage points

3. Which causal conclusion is established?

- A The redesign alone caused the decline.
- C The decline proves there was no measurement issue.

- B The outage explains every lost purchase.
- D The cause is not isolated by this before-and-after comparison.

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

checkout conversion

Completed purchasing sessions divided by the specified checkout-session base.

IN USE measure checkout conversion

conversion funnel

The ordered steps toward a defined customer action.

IN USE examine the conversion funnel

checkout abandonment

Failure to complete a purchase after entering checkout.

IN USE investigate checkout abandonment

eligible session

A session meeting the stated inclusion criteria.

IN USE define eligible sessions

purchase event

A recorded event representing a purchase action.

IN USE validate the purchase event

event instrumentation

The implementation of event collection in a digital product.

IN USE audit event instrumentation

duplicate event

An event recorded more than once for the same action.

IN USE remove duplicate events

deduplication

Identifying and handling repeated records of the same event.

IN USE validate deduplication

denominator

The base quantity used in a rate calculation.

IN USE keep the denominator consistent

percentage point

One unit of difference between percentage rates.

IN USE report a percentage-point change

relative change

A change expressed as a proportion of its initial value.

IN USE calculate relative change

traffic mix

The composition of visitors by relevant source or characteristic.

IN USE compare traffic mix

Precision check

The conversion rate fell from 40% to 32%: eight percentage points, or a 20% relative decline from the original rate. These are two descriptions of the same change, not interchangeable units.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

device segment

A group of users or sessions using a specified device type.

IN USE analyze a device segment

payment failure

An unsuccessful payment attempt under the relevant process.

IN USE investigate payment failures

payment gateway

A service connecting a checkout to payment processing.

IN USE monitor the payment gateway

provider outage

A disruption to a third-party service.

IN USE isolate the provider outage

confounder

A factor that complicates a causal interpretation.

IN USE identify a confounder

causal attribution

Assigning an observed outcome to its cause.

IN USE qualify causal attribution

controlled experiment

A comparison designed to isolate an intervention's effect.

IN USE run a controlled experiment

random assignment

Allocation by chance to comparison groups.

IN USE verify random assignment

cohort

A group sharing a defined characteristic or starting event.

IN USE define a cohort

user experience (UX)

A person's experience of interacting with a product or service.

IN USE assess the user experience

friction

An obstacle making a customer action harder.

IN USE reduce checkout friction

rollback

Returning a change to an earlier version.

IN USE evaluate a rollback

Precision check

This metric counts sessions completing a purchase, not purchase events or purchased items. A session can contain multiple events. Verify collection, deduplication, eligibility, device mix, and outage exposure before attributing the change.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE OBSERVED RESULT

"Checkout conversion fell from forty to thirty-two percent."

GIVE THE RELATIVE COMPARISON

"Relative to the original rate, the decline is twenty percent."

PROTECT THE DENOMINATOR

"Both periods contain one thousand eligible checkout sessions."

LIMIT CAUSALITY

"This comparison does not isolate the redesign's effect."

USE THE CORRECT ABSOLUTE UNIT

"That is a decline of eight percentage points."

DEFINE THE COUNTED OUTCOME

"We count a session once if it completes a purchase."

NAME THE COMPETING EVENT

"A payment-provider outage overlapped the later period."

REQUEST A MEASUREMENT CHECK

"Has event collection remained consistent across the release?"

Fell from ... to ...

Makes both rates explicit before discussing their difference.

Percentage points

Measures the absolute distance between two percentage rates.

Relative to

Identifies the initial value used for relative change.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE EVENTS AND SESSIONS

"More purchase events do not necessarily mean more purchasing sessions."

INVESTIGATE THE OUTAGE

"Separate affected and unaffected time intervals."

RECOGNIZE THE BUSINESS PROBLEM

"Uncertain attribution does not make the decline unimportant."

KEEP A DECISION CONDITIONAL

"A rollback decision should use the full risk and performance evidence."

CHECK COMPOSITION

"Compare traffic and device mix before interpreting the aggregate."

AVOID A NEW OVERCLAIM

"That breakdown would be informative, not automatically causal."

DEFINE A NEXT ANALYSIS

"Validate the data, then compare the relevant segments."

SUMMARIZE THE FINDING

"We have a measured decline and an unresolved explanation."

Overlapped

Shows co-occurrence without claiming a complete explanation.

Does not isolate

Limits causal inference, not the existence of the observed result.

Not automatically

Prevents a useful diagnostic from becoming an unsupported proof.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which sentence uses the correct units?

- A** Conversion fell eight percent relative and twenty percentage points.
- B** Conversion fell thirty-two percentage points.
- C** Conversion rose because session counts were unchanged.
- D** Conversion fell eight percentage points, a twenty-percent relative decline.

2. Which denominator belongs in this report?

- A** Purchased items
- B** All recorded purchase events
- C** Only sessions that purchased
- D** Eligible checkout sessions

3. Which statement overclaims causality?

- A** The redesign caused the entire decline.
- B** The decline coincided with a provider outage.
- C** Measurement consistency needs checking.
- D** The later rate was thirty-two percent.

4. Which diagnostic is useful but not automatically causal proof?

- A** Count duplicate events as separate successful sessions.
- B** Compare outage-affected intervals with unaffected intervals while checking their differences.
- C** Assume all missing purchases were outage-related.
- D** Ignore device mix because totals match.

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

A checkout decline with two competing explanations

E Conversations / turns 1-10

05

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

device segment / event instrumentation / traffic mix / checkout conversion / denominator / percentage points / deduplication / causal attribution / provider outage / rollback

- 01 **Mara:** Checkout is down after the redesign. The release team wants a rollback recommendation this morning. What can we actually conclude from this chart?
- 02 **Dev:** The ¹ _____ rate did fall, from forty to thirty-two percent. We should acknowledge that result, but the before-and-after chart alone does not identify the cause.
- 03 **Mara:** I wrote an eight-percent decline in my draft. Is that the clearest description?
- 04 **Dev:** Use eight ² _____ for the absolute change. The relative decline is twenty percent because we divide the eight-point difference by the original forty-percent rate.
- 05 **Mara:** Both periods had one thousand checkout sessions. Does that make the comparison fully controlled?
- 06 **Dev:** No. A common ³ _____ count does not make the visitors or conditions identical. We still need to verify eligibility, measurement, and the composition of the sessions.
- 07 **Mara:** The payment provider was down during part of the later period. That seems important.
- 08 **Dev:** The ⁴ _____ is a competing explanation we must investigate. We cannot ignore it, but we also cannot assume it accounts for every missing purchase.
- 09 **Mara:** Can we compare the affected hours with the unaffected hours?
- 10 **Dev:** Yes, while checking ⁵ _____. Those intervals may attract different visitors. The breakdown can identify patterns, but it is not automatically a controlled estimate of the redesign's effect.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

05

- 11 **Mara:** The developers changed some analytics code during the release. Could that affect the result?
- 12 **Dev:** We should audit ⁶ _____. Confirm that checkout entry and completion are captured consistently. Otherwise an apparent behavior change may include a measurement change.
- 13 **Mara:** The purchase-event count is higher than the number of purchasing sessions. Is the dashboard necessarily wrong?
- 14 **Dev:** Not necessarily. Check ⁷ _____ and the metric definition. This report counts each eligible purchasing session at most once, not every purchase event or every item purchased.
- 15 **Mara:** So the same session could produce several recorded events without becoming several successful sessions.
- 16 **Dev:** Exactly. Then examine each relevant ⁸ _____. A mobile-specific issue would be useful to locate, but we should not invent one before seeing the breakdown.
- 17 **Mara:** We still need to make a release decision. Which checks can we finish first, and what would remain uncertain afterward?
- 18 **Dev:** Agreed. Evaluate a ⁹ _____ alongside the actual risks and diagnostics. My caution concerns the explanation, not whether the decline deserves urgent attention.
- 19 **Mara:** I will report the two rates, the outage, and the checks we are doing before claiming a cause.
- 20 **Dev:** That keeps ¹⁰ _____ honest. We have a real reported decline, several testable questions, and a clear next analysis. That is more useful than blaming the release from one chart.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. checkout conversion | 2. percentage points | 3. denominator | 4. provider outage | 5. traffic mix | 6. event instrumentation | 7. deduplication | 8. device segment | 9. rollback | 10. causal attribution

Explain a second conversion comparison

F Say it

A fixed report counts 300 purchasing sessions out of 600 eligible sessions before a change and 240 out of 600 afterward. One session counts at most once.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

20% / 40% / ten percentage points / 50%

Lead: "The original rate was ¹ _____."

Analyst: "The later rate was ² _____."

Lead: "The absolute decline was ³ _____."

Analyst: "The relative decline was ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. 50% | 2. 40% | 3. ten percentage points | 4. 20%

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10; say the decline in percentage points and as a relative percentage.
2. Swap roles for turns 11-20; separate purchasing sessions from purchase events.
3. Complete the transfer and check the denominator before explaining the change.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The supplier with more defects has the lower rate

A Read the situation

Challenge a vendor scorecard by specifying the unit, denominator, period, and comparison limits.

06

A July scorecard shows Vendor K with ten defective units and Vendor M with five. The heading says K has the higher defect rate. Receiving records show 800 units received from K and 200 from M in July. Count each defective unit once, even if it has several faults; all counts refer to these July receipts. Product mix and inspection intensity have not been confirmed as comparable. Vendor manager Rosa and supplier representative Malik must correct the rate comparison before discussing causes or commercial deductions.

PEOPLE / Rosa: Vendor manager | Malik: Supplier representative

MAKE THE DISPUTED NUMBER REPRODUCIBLE

Supplier discussions can become adversarial when a scorecard is treated as unquestionable. Ask for the counted unit and denominator, then do the calculation together. Correcting a ranking does not excuse the underlying defects or establish which party caused them.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is Vendor K's defective-unit rate?

A 10%

B 5%

C 2.5%

D 1.25%

2. What is Vendor M's defective-unit rate?

A 5%

B 0.625%

C 2.5%

D 1.25%

3. What remains unverified?

A K's July received count

B M's July defective-unit count

C The stated counting rule

D Comparable product mix and inspection intensity

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

vendor scorecard

A report comparing supplier performance against defined measures.

IN USE correct a vendor scorecard

defective-unit rate

Defective units divided by the specified unit population.

IN USE calculate the defective-unit rate

defect count

The number of individual faults identified.

IN USE distinguish the defect count

received units

Units recorded as received within the defined scope.

IN USE confirm received units

inspection intensity

The extent or frequency of examination.

IN USE compare inspection intensity

product mix

The composition of products within a measured group.

IN USE control for product mix

reporting period

The time interval covered by a measure.

IN USE specify the reporting period

purchase order

A buyer's formal order specifying the relevant purchase terms.

IN USE reconcile the purchase order

vendor allowance

A supplier-funded amount under agreed commercial terms.

IN USE verify a vendor allowance

chargeback

A commercial deduction or charge asserted under applicable terms.

IN USE dispute a vendor chargeback

supplier corrective action

An action addressing an established supplier-related problem.

IN USE request supplier corrective action

root cause

The underlying reason for a problem, supported by investigation.

IN USE establish the root cause

Precision check

A count is not a rate. K has more defective units but a lower defective-unit rate: $10/800 = 1.25\%$, compared with M at $5/200 = 2.5\%$. Each defective unit is counted only once.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

acceptance criterion

A requirement used to determine whether goods meet expectations.

IN USE confirm the acceptance criterion

inspection record

Evidence of what was examined and found.

IN USE retrieve the inspection record

sample size

The number of units examined in a sample.

IN USE state the sample size

lot

A defined group of goods identified for traceability.

IN USE trace the affected lot

return to vendor

Sending goods back to the supplying party.

IN USE authorize a return to vendor

marketplace listing

A product offer displayed on a marketplace.

IN USE update the marketplace listing

seller of record

The party identified as the seller for the transaction.

IN USE identify the seller of record

catalog attribute

A structured product detail such as size or material.

IN USE correct a catalog attribute

content compliance

Conformity with applicable product-content requirements.

IN USE review content compliance

service-level agreement

Terms defining expected service performance and responsibilities.

IN USE review the service-level agreement

dispute evidence

Records supporting a challenge to a claim or deduction.

IN USE submit dispute evidence

remediation plan

A defined set of actions to address a problem.

IN USE agree a remediation plan

06

Precision check

A lower observed rate does not prove better inherent quality when inspection and product mix differ. The scorecard does not itself establish root cause, supplier liability, or the right to a commercial deduction.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ASK FOR THE BASE

"What received-unit denominator is behind this rate?"

CLARIFY THE COUNTED OBJECT

"Count each defective unit once, not every fault separately."

SHOW THE CALCULATION

"Ten divided by eight hundred gives 1.25%."

KEEP DEFECTS VISIBLE

"Correcting the ranking does not remove the ten defective units."

STATE THE PERIOD

"Both figures refer to July receipts."

CORRECT THE LABEL

"Ten is a count, not a percentage."

COMPARE ACCURATELY

"K has the larger count but the lower observed rate."

CHECK COMPARABILITY

"Were product mix and inspection intensity comparable?"

06

Observed rate

Restricts the comparison to recorded data, not inherent supplier quality.

Count each ... once

Defines the unit and prevents double-counting multiple faults.

Behind this rate

Requests the denominator supporting the displayed percentage.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

REQUEST TRACEABLE EVIDENCE

"Please link the findings to the relevant lots and inspection records."

SEPARATE COMMERCIAL AUTHORITY

"A scorecard result does not automatically authorize a deduction."

KEEP THE CHALLENGE CONSTRUCTIVE

"I am challenging the rate label, not dismissing the reported defects."

DEFINE THE FOLLOW-UP

"Review the defect evidence and the comparison basis separately."

AVOID AN UNSUPPORTED CAUSE

"These numbers do not establish how the damage occurred."

CHECK THE TERMS

"We need the applicable agreement before deciding any chargeback."

AGREE A CORRECTION

"Let us republish the rates with their denominators."

CLOSE THE DISPUTE PRECISELY

"The arithmetic is corrected; the cause and commercial outcome remain open."

06

Not dismissing

Preserves the substantive concern while challenging its description.

Automatically

Flags an unsupported leap from a metric to an entitlement.

Remain open

Keeps unresolved questions distinct from the corrected arithmetic.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

1. Which ranking is arithmetically correct?

- A** K has a higher rate because ten exceeds five.
- B** Both rates are equal because both have defects.
- C** M's rate is five percent regardless of receipts.
- D** K has a lower defective-unit rate than M.

2. If one unit has three faults, how is it counted here?

- A** As three received units
- B** As no defective units
- C** As one defective unit
- D** As three defective units

3. Which claim still needs investigation?

- A** K has better inherent quality under comparable conditions.
- B** K received 800 units in July.
- C** M had five defective units.
- D** K's observed rate is 1.25%.

4. Which action is not authorized merely by the scorecard?

- A** Requesting inspection records
- B** Deducting a chargeback from the supplier's invoice
- C** Correcting the rate arithmetic
- D** Stating the received-unit counts

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

The supplier with more defects has the lower rate

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

defective-unit rate / product mix / received units / vendor scorecard / reporting period / root cause / defect count / inspection record / chargeback / remediation plan

- 01 **Rosa:** Your July scorecard is flagged red: ten defective units, compared with M's five. Before the review, can we check whether that ranking uses the right base?
- 02 **Malik:** Could we check the ¹ _____ behind those figures? I am not disputing the ten reported units, but the heading compares rates while the table only shows counts.
- 03 **Rosa:** The receiving file has eight hundred units from K and two hundred from M.
- 04 **Malik:** Then our ² _____ is one point two five percent, while M's is two point five percent. The larger defect count does not make our rate higher.
- 05 **Rosa:** You are right about the calculation. We should correct that before it goes into the supplier review.
- 06 **Malik:** Please also state the ³ _____. I understand these counts all refer to July receipts. A rate could still be misleading if the defects came from a different receipt period.
- 07 **Rosa:** They all relate to July. Some units had several faults; the inspection team counted each affected unit once.
- 08 **Malik:** Good. That distinguishes defective units from ⁴ _____. We should preserve that rule in the scorecard so next month's calculation does not silently change.
- 09 **Rosa:** Does the lower rate mean K has better quality overall?
- 10 **Malik:** It is a lower observed rate, but we need to compare ⁵ _____ and inspection intensity before making that broader claim. I would not use the corrected arithmetic to dismiss the ten units.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Rosa:** The inspection details should tell us what failed and how the goods were examined.
- 12 **Malik:** Please share the relevant ⁶ _____ through the agreed channel. We can review the lot references and acceptance criteria rather than argue over an unexplained total.
- 13 **Rosa:** Operations suspects the packaging caused the damage, but the report has not established that.
- 14 **Malik:** Then packaging is a hypothesis, not a confirmed ⁷ _____. We should examine the evidence and handling history before assigning responsibility. A useful correction depends on identifying the actual problem.
- 15 **Rosa:** Commercial wants to deduct a fee from the next invoice. Which inspection records and contract terms do we need to review with you first?
- 16 **Malik:** Any ⁸ _____ needs the applicable terms and evidence. Correcting the rate does not decide that question, and the original heading does not automatically establish a right to deduct.
- 17 **Rosa:** I will separate the metric correction from the quality investigation and the commercial discussion.
- 18 **Malik:** That works. We can agree a ⁹ _____ when the findings support the actions. Let us not promise a packaging change merely to close the meeting.
- 19 **Rosa:** I will republish both denominators, the July period, and the corrected percentages. The ten affected units will remain visible.
- 20 **Malik:** Thank you. The revised ¹⁰ _____ will then support a fair discussion. We can acknowledge the quality concern while keeping the arithmetic, causal investigation, and contract issues distinct.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. received units | 2. defective-unit rate | 3. reporting period | 4. defect count | 5. product mix | 6. inspection record | 7. root cause | 8. chargeback | 9. remediation plan | 10. vendor scorecard

Correct a second supplier ranking

F Say it

For the same month, Vendor P has six defective units among 600 received; Vendor Q has four among 200. Count each defective unit once.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Q / 1% / 2% / P

Manager: "P's defective-unit rate is ¹ _____."

Supplier: "Q's defective-unit rate is ² _____."

Manager: "The larger defective-unit count belongs to ³ _____."

Supplier: "The higher defective-unit rate belongs to ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. 1% | 2. 2% | 3. P | 4. Q

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10; challenge the rate using each vendor's received-unit denominator.
2. Swap roles for turns 11-20; distinguish a corrected metric from a supported chargeback.
3. Complete the transfer and count each defective unit only once.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A return request beyond the goodwill window

A Read the situation

Acknowledge a customer request, explain a bounded exception review, and distinguish policy from applicable rights.

Customer Owen wants to return an unworn \$80 jacket because he changed his mind. His request is on day 35; the retailer states a 30-day change-of-mind return window for this purchase. No fault or misdescription is alleged. Agent Elena cannot approve a goodwill exception but can submit a review to the store manager. No review outcome is supplied. Before treating the policy as decisive, the team must check any applicable customer rights and transaction facts. A fault complaint would require a different assessment, not an automatic rejection under the goodwill window.

PEOPLE / Owen: Customer | Elena: Service representative

07

EMPATHY IS NOT AN APPROVAL FORMULA

An apologetic tone can accidentally sound like a refund commitment. Acknowledge the inconvenience, then state exactly what can happen next. Avoid describing a customer as difficult merely because the requested remedy is outside your authority.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Why does Owen want to return the jacket?

- A A recall notice requires its return.
- C The jacket is alleged to be faulty.

- B He changed his mind.
- D The wrong product was delivered.

2. What can Elena authorize herself?

- A A guaranteed exchange
- C Submission of a manager review, not approval of the exception

- B A binding extension of every return window
- D An immediate \$80 refund

3. How should the 30-day policy be treated?

- A As a universal legal limit for every transaction
- C As proof the jacket is defective

- B As irrelevant to any review
- D As a stated policy that does not override applicable rights

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

change-of-mind return

A return requested because the customer no longer wants the item.

IN USE handle a change-of-mind return

return window

The period specified for a return under particular terms.

IN USE check the return window

goodwill exception

A discretionary departure from policy where permitted.

IN USE request a goodwill exception

exception authority

The defined power to approve a policy departure.

IN USE confirm exception authority

proof of purchase

Evidence identifying a purchase and its relevant details.

IN USE verify proof of purchase

purchase channel

The route through which the customer bought the item.

IN USE identify the purchase channel

item condition

The physical state of a product.

IN USE assess item condition

original payment method

The payment route used for the original purchase.

IN USE verify the original payment method

store credit

Value available for a future purchase from the retailer.

IN USE explain store credit

exchange

Replacing a purchased item with another under relevant terms.

IN USE authorize an exchange

refund

Return of an amount paid.

IN USE confirm a refund

manager review

Assessment by the person assigned the relevant decision authority.

IN USE submit a manager review

Precision check

This is a change-of-mind request on day 35, not an established fault claim. Record the actual reason accurately. The 30-day policy is a fictional retailer rule for this purchase, not a universal statement of consumer law.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

fault allegation

A customer's statement that a product has a defect.

IN USE record a fault allegation

misdescription

A mismatch between an item and its stated description.

IN USE investigate misdescription

applicable rights

Customer protections relevant to the actual transaction.

IN USE check applicable rights

statutory remedy

A remedy arising under the relevant law.

IN USE distinguish a statutory remedy

policy discretion

Permitted choice within an organization's policy authority.

IN USE explain policy discretion

escalation route

The defined path to a higher or specialist review.

IN USE offer an escalation route

complaint record

A documented account of a customer's concern and its handling.

IN USE maintain a complaint record

case owner

The person responsible for coordinating the case.

IN USE identify the case owner

review outcome

The result of an assessment.

IN USE communicate the review outcome

reason code

A structured label describing the basis for a transaction or request.

IN USE select the correct reason code

resolution option

A possible way to address the customer's concern.

IN USE verify resolution options

service handoff

Transfer of relevant context and responsibility to another team member.

IN USE complete a service handoff

Precision check

Submitting a review does not approve a refund, exchange, or store credit. Applicable rights must be checked separately; a retailer cannot replace a required remedy with discretionary goodwill merely by changing the label.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE REQUEST

"You would like to return the unworn jacket because you changed your mind."

STATE THE POLICY CAREFULLY

"The stated change-of-mind window for this purchase is thirty days."

EXPLAIN YOUR AUTHORITY

"I can submit the request, but I cannot approve an exception myself."

AVOID A GUARANTEED OUTCOME

"Submission does not guarantee a refund or exchange."

IDENTIFY THE TIMING

"This request is on day thirty-five."

KEEP RIGHTS SEPARATE

"We also need to check the rights applicable to the actual transaction."

OFFER THE REAL NEXT STEP

"I can refer this to the store manager for review."

REQUEST RELEVANT EVIDENCE

"Please provide the purchase details through our approved process."

For this purchase

Limits a policy statement to its actual transaction context.

I can ... but I cannot

Separates a permitted action from an unheld authority.

Would you like

Seeks the customer's choice about the offered review.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

RESPECT THE CUSTOMER'S CHOICE

"Would you like me to submit that review?"

DISTINGUISH A NEW ALLEGATION

"If you are reporting a fault, I need to record and assess that separately."

REDUCE REPETITION

"I will include the details you have already supplied."

KEEP THE HANDOFF USEFUL

"The record will show the timing, reason, item condition, and requested remedy."

RECORD THE CORRECT REASON

"I will record this as a change-of-mind request."

AVOID AN INVENTED SUBSTITUTE

"Store credit has not been approved either."

NAME THE DECISION-MAKER

"The manager holds the stated exception authority."

CLOSE HONESTLY

"I will communicate the actual review outcome without promising it in advance."

Has not been approved

Prevents an alternative remedy from being implied as available.

If you are reporting

Distinguishes a new factual allegation requiring a different assessment.

Without promising

Preserves a clear process commitment while leaving the decision open.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which sentence stays within Elena's authority?

- A** I have extended the policy for every customer.
- B** I can submit a manager review, but I cannot guarantee its outcome.
- C** I can guarantee the manager will approve this.
- D** Store credit is automatically yours because a refund is unavailable.

2. Which record best matches the stated request?

- A** Misdescription established; exchange mandatory
- B** Customer withdrew the request
- C** Change of mind; unworn jacket; day 35; \$80 purchase
- D** Confirmed product defect; refund approved

3. Which response to a newly alleged fault is appropriate?

- A** Promise a refund before checking any facts.
- B** Record the allegation and assess the applicable rights and process separately.
- C** Reject it automatically because the goodwill window ended.
- D** Change the label to avoid an investigation.

4. Which phrase asks permission without implying approval?

- A** The manager has accepted the request.
- B** Your exception is guaranteed.
- C** Would you like me to submit the review?
- D** Your refund is being processed.

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

A return request beyond the goodwill window

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

change-of-mind return / manager review / return window / fault allegation / exception authority / goodwill exception / proof of purchase / complaint record / service handoff / store credit

07

- 01 **Owen:** I paid eighty dollars for this jacket and have not worn it. I chose the wrong style. I am five days outside the return window; is a review possible?
- 02 **Elena:** You are asking for a ¹ _____ on day thirty-five. I understand you would prefer not to keep an unworn item. Let me explain what I can do without promising a decision I cannot make.
- 03 **Owen:** The receipt says thirty days. Is there any way to ask someone to look at it?
- 04 **Elena:** Yes. The stated ² _____ is thirty days for this purchase. We also need to check the actual transaction and applicable rights rather than treat that policy as a universal legal answer.
- 05 **Owen:** I am not saying there is anything wrong with it. I simply chose the wrong style for myself.
- 06 **Elena:** I will record that accurately. I can request a ³ _____, but I cannot approve one myself. The store manager can assess the request under the relevant process.
- 07 **Owen:** If you send it to the manager, does that mean I will get the money back?
- 08 **Elena:** No. A ⁴ _____ is a request for a decision, not the decision itself. I do not want you to hear a refund promise when I am offering a review.
- 09 **Owen:** Would store credit be easier? I would be willing to buy something else here.
- 10 **Elena:** I can include that preference, but ⁵ _____ has not been approved either. I should not present it as an automatic substitute simply because the original request is outside the stated window.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Owen:** All right. What information does the manager need from me?
- 12 **Elena:** We need the relevant ⁶ _____, the item condition, and your requested remedy through the approved process. I will include what you have already told me so you do not have to start again.
- 13 **Owen:** I have the receipt and the jacket with its tags. Please submit the request.
- 14 **Elena:** I will. The manager has the ⁷ _____ described in our process. I will keep your reason and preferred outcomes clear rather than suggest the jacket is faulty to make the request sound stronger.
- 15 **Owen:** Suppose I later notice a fault. Would the thirty-day window automatically rule that out too?
- 16 **Elena:** A ⁸ _____ would need to be recorded and assessed separately under the applicable rights and facts. I cannot decide that hypothetical claim from the change-of-mind policy alone.
- 17 **Owen:** That is clear. For now, it is just the style, and I would like the review.
- 18 **Elena:** The ⁹ _____ will show the eighty-dollar jacket, unworn condition, day thirty-five, and your preference. It will not say a refund or exchange has already been agreed.
- 19 **Owen:** Please include the receipt details in the handoff. I would rather not start again when the manager responds.
- 20 **Elena:** I will preserve that in the ¹⁰ _____. The next response should communicate the actual assessment and explain the available next step, not make you reconstruct this conversation.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. change-of-mind return | 2. return window | 3. goodwill exception | 4. manager review | 5. store credit | 6. proof of purchase | 7. exception authority | 8. fault allegation | 9. complaint record | 10. service handoff

Keep another review within its authority

F Say it

A customer requests a change-of-mind return on day 22 under a stated 14-day policy. Agent Noor may submit a review to manager Beth but cannot approve it. No outcome is supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

07

WORD + PHRASE BANK

14 / 22 / approval / Beth

Noor: "The request is on day ¹ _____."

Customer: "The stated policy window is ² _____ days."

Noor: "The manager reviewing the request is ³ _____."

Customer: "Submission does not guarantee ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. 22 | 2. 14 | 3. Beth | 4. approval

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10; acknowledge the request without promising an exception.
2. Swap roles for turns 11-20; keep a change-of-mind request distinct from a fault report.
3. Complete the transfer and identify who submits the request and who decides it.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Ready online, incomplete on the pickup shelf

A Read the situation

Give an actionable shift handoff that corrects a false pickup status without hiding the missing item.

At 16:00, pickup order P64 shows ready online. It contains three items: a notebook, a pen set, and a mug. Staff have located and staged the notebook and pen set, but cannot find the mug. No substitute has been approved. Outgoing lead Talia must hand the issue to incoming lead Evan, who will contact the customer and update the case at 16:30. The local process requires every ordered item to be verified and staged before the whole order is marked ready. Partial pickup needs the permitted process and the customer's agreement.

PEOPLE / Talia: Outgoing shift lead | Evan: Incoming shift lead

08

HANDOVER LANGUAGE MUST SUPPORT THE NEXT ACTION

A cheerful all sorted can conceal an unfinished customer problem. Name the item, the physical status, the system discrepancy, and the next owner. The incoming colleague needs enough detail to act without repeating the search or misleading the customer.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which item has not been located?

A The mug

B The notebook

C The pen set

D All three items

2. What does the local whole-order ready status require?

A A shift handoff completed

B Every ordered item verified and staged

C Any one item scanned

D A label printed

3. Who owns the next customer contact?

A The customer

B Evan

C Talia after she leaves

D An unnamed carrier

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

omnichannel

Coordinated retail activity across store and digital channels.

IN USE coordinate omnichannel execution

buy online, pick up in store (BOPIS)

Ordering online for collection at a store.

IN USE fulfill a BOPIS order

click and collect

An online order collected from a designated location.

IN USE manage click-and-collect orders

order management system (OMS)

Software coordinating order information and fulfillment status.

IN USE update the OMS

point of sale (POS)

The system or place where a retail sale is processed.

IN USE reconcile POS records

picking

Retrieving the specified items for an order.

IN USE complete order picking

pick list

A list of items and quantities to retrieve.

IN USE verify the pick list

staging

Placing picked items in the designated holding area.

IN USE confirm order staging

pickup shelf

The area holding orders prepared for collection.

IN USE check the pickup shelf

ready-for-pickup status

A status indicating the specified readiness conditions are met.

IN USE correct ready-for-pickup status

short pick

A pick in which the required quantity cannot be found or supplied.

IN USE record a short pick

item-level status

The state recorded for an individual order item.

IN USE update item-level status

Precision check

Two staged items do not make this three-item order ready under the stated local process. A missing mug is not evidence that it was collected, canceled, or refunded. Keep each status tied to its actual event.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

order-level status

The overall state recorded for the complete order.

IN USE correct order-level status

substitution

Supplying a different item in place of the ordered one.

IN USE confirm a substitution

customer consent

The customer's agreement to a proposed action.

IN USE obtain customer consent

partial pickup

Collection of only part of the ordered items.

IN USE arrange partial pickup

pickup notification

A message telling the customer about collection readiness.

IN USE correct a pickup notification

collection verification

Checking the required identity or order details at pickup.

IN USE complete collection verification

cancellation line

An order item recorded for cancellation under the process.

IN USE confirm a cancellation line

refund status

The actual stage of returning the relevant payment.

IN USE verify refund status

shift handoff

Transfer of work status and responsibility between shifts.

IN USE give a shift handoff

action owner

The person responsible for a specified next action.

IN USE name the action owner

discrepancy log

A record of mismatches requiring follow-up.

IN USE update the discrepancy log

resolution checkpoint

A scheduled point to review progress on an open issue.

IN USE set a resolution checkpoint

Precision check

Partial pickup and substitution are different options. Neither should be assumed from silence or staff convenience. Use the permitted process, obtain the necessary customer agreement, and preserve the remaining item and payment status.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

START WITH THE ORDER

"This handoff concerns pickup order P64."

NAME THE GAP

"The mug has not been found."

APPLY THE LOCAL RULE

"Whole-order readiness requires all three items to be verified and staged."

PROTECT THE REMAINING ITEMS

"Keep the two staged items identified with this order."

STATE THE VERIFIED ITEMS

"The notebook and pen set are located and staged."

IDENTIFY THE CONTRADICTION

"The website says ready, but the order is incomplete."

CORRECT THE VISIBLE STATUS

"We need to correct the ready message through the approved process."

REJECT AN ASSUMED SUBSTITUTE

"No substitute has been approved."

08

Located and staged

Describes physical preparation, not simply a system entry.

Has not been found

States the search result without inventing theft or cancellation.

Through the approved process

Makes the correction traceable and properly authorized.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

OFFER A BOUNDED CHOICE

"Check whether partial pickup is permitted and whether the customer agrees."

SET THE CHECKPOINT

"Update the case at 16:30."

KEEP MONEY STATUS SEPARATE

"Do not mark a refund complete unless it has actually reached that status."

PRESERVE THE OPEN ITEM

"The mug remains unresolved until its actual disposition is recorded."

ASSIGN THE NEXT ACTION

"Evan will contact the customer."

LIMIT THE PROMISE

"That is a review time, not a promise that the mug will be found."

REDUCE REPEATED WORK

"Record which locations have already been checked."

CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"Confirm the owner, customer message, and outstanding item before leaving."

08

Whether ... and whether ...

Separates process permission from customer agreement.

Not a promise

Keeps a scheduled checkpoint from becoming a guaranteed result.

Actual disposition

Refers to what truly happened to the missing order line.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handoff is actionable?

- A** P64 is sorted; the next shift can check later.
- B** All items are ready because the website says so.
- C** The mug must have been collected because it is absent.
- D** P64: two items staged, mug missing, ready status incorrect; Evan contacts customer and updates at 16:30.

2. Which substitution claim is supported?

- A** The pen set replaces the mug automatically.
- B** Silence from the customer confirms a substitution.
- C** No substitute has been approved.
- D** Any similar mug may be supplied without agreement.

3. What does 16:30 mean?

- A** Automatic cancellation of the whole order
- B** A case-update checkpoint
- C** Guaranteed completion of the missing-item search
- D** A confirmed refund completion time

4. Which record would invent an event?

- A** Marking the missing mug as collected because staff cannot find it
- B** Keeping the mug unresolved
- C** Recording the two staged items
- D** Correcting the unsupported ready message

Answers and explanations: page 99.

Ready online, incomplete on the pickup shelf

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

resolution checkpoint / action owner / partial pickup / short pick / pickup notification / substitution / refund status / order-level status / staging / discrepancy log

08

- 01 **Talia:** Can I hand over P64 before I leave? It says ready online, but I can only account for the notebook and pen set on the pickup shelf.
- 02 **Evan:** Then the ¹ _____ does not match the physical position. Which item is missing, and have we confirmed the other two belong to this order?
- 03 **Talia:** The mug has not been found. The notebook and pen set are identified for P64 and are already in the designated holding area.
- 04 **Evan:** Keep that ² _____ information in the handoff. We should protect those items while we investigate the mug, not return them to general stock without a proper reason.
- 05 **Talia:** The online message may already have encouraged the customer to come in. We need to correct that before they make an unnecessary journey.
- 06 **Evan:** I will address the ³ _____ and contact the customer. Our local process requires all three items to be verified and staged before the entire order is ready.
- 07 **Talia:** Could we tell them to collect the two items while we continue the search?
- 08 **Evan:** We can check whether ⁴ _____ is permitted and ask whether that works for them. We should not assume they want two trips or silently treat the missing line as complete.
- 09 **Talia:** There is another mug on display, but it is not the one ordered. Please check with the customer before offering it as a substitute.
- 10 **Evan:** Then there is no approved ⁵ _____. Similar appearance is not enough. The customer may have chosen the specific size or design for a reason.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Talia:** I will list the locations already checked so your team does not repeat the same search.
- 12 **Evan:** Good. Record the ⁶ _____ against the mug and preserve the actual item details. Do not infer theft, collection, or cancellation simply because we cannot find it.
- 13 **Talia:** You will own the customer contact after the shift change. Shall we set a review at half past four?
- 14 **Evan:** Yes. I am the ⁷ _____, and I will update the case at sixteen thirty. That gives the team a clear next contact without promising the mug will be found by then.
- 15 **Talia:** If the customer asks to cancel the missing item, we should follow the actual cancellation and payment process.
- 16 **Evan:** Correct. Keep ⁸ _____ separate from the request. We must not tell the customer money has been returned before that is supported by the relevant record.
- 17 **Talia:** I will leave P64 open with two staged items, the missing mug, the incorrect ready message, and the search history.
- 18 **Evan:** Add those points to the ⁹ _____. I will correct the customer-facing position through the approved process and make the offered options explicit when we speak.
- 19 **Talia:** That is everything from my side. Please confirm that you have the order details and the scheduled update.
- 20 **Evan:** Confirmed. The ¹⁰ _____ is sixteen thirty, and the mug remains unresolved. I will carry the customer contact and record the actual next decision instead of allowing the ready label to stand.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. order-level status | 2. staging | 3. pickup notification | 4. partial pickup | 5. substitution | 6. short pick | 7. action owner | 8. refund status | 9. discrepancy log | 10. resolution checkpoint

Give a second pickup handoff

F Say it

Order C17 contains four items. Three are staged; a desk lamp is missing. Incoming lead Jun owns the next customer contact and will update the case at 18:00. No substitute is approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

desk lamp / C17 / Jun / 18:00

08

Outgoing lead: "The order reference is ¹ _____."

Jun: "The missing item is the ² _____."

Outgoing lead: "The next contact owner is ³ _____."

Jun: "The next case update is at ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. C17 | 2. desk lamp | 3. Jun | 4. 18:00

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10; compare the ready message with the three actual item states.
2. Swap roles for turns 11-20; confirm the contact owner and update time.
3. Complete the transfer without turning a review time into a promise of stock.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Sales are not the bank payout

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Reconcile marketplace receipts, refunds, fees, and reserved funds without calling every difference a loss.

Fictional marketplace statement: \$5,000 captured item sales, \$400 refunds, \$300 nonrefundable fees, and \$200 newly reserved. No opening balance, tax, shipping, currency conversion, or other adjustments. The resulting payout has been issued but is not yet confirmed received by the bank. The reserve release date is unspecified.

PEOPLE / Nora: Marketplace manager | Felix: Finance analyst

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

09

WORD + PHRASE BANK

settlement statement / processing fees / bank receipt / reserve hold / reserve release / reconciliation trail

- 01 **Nora:** The marketplace shows five thousand in sales, but the payout is only four thousand one hundred. Have we lost nine hundred dollars somewhere?
- 02 **Felix:** Let us follow the ¹ _____. Four hundred went back to customers, three hundred is fees, and two hundred has been reserved.
- 03 **Nora:** After the refunds, that leaves four thousand six hundred. I had treated that as the amount we should see in the bank.
- 04 **Felix:** That is sales less the supplied refunds, before the other statement adjustments. The ² _____ reduce the amount available for payout by another three hundred.
- 05 **Nora:** So we are at four thousand three hundred before the reserve. Is the reserved two hundred another fee?
- 06 **Felix:** No. The ³ _____ is money set aside under these terms. It is not the same as a nonrefundable charge.
- 07 **Nora:** Then the reconciliation is five thousand, less four hundred, less three hundred, less two hundred: four thousand one hundred issued.
- 08 **Felix:** Exactly. Keep the four lines visible. If we label the entire nine-hundred difference as marketplace commission, both the refund and reserve explanations disappear.
- 09 **Nora:** The dashboard says the payout has been issued. Can I mark it received in our cash report now?
- 10 **Felix:** Check the ⁴ _____ first. The bank has not confirmed it in our supplied record, so keep the transfer outstanding for reconciliation.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Nora:** I will match the payout reference against the bank entry when it appears. An equal amount alone might not identify the right transfer.
- 12 **Felix:** Good. Retain the reference, amount, currency, and dates. Also make sure the refund rows belong to this settlement rather than subtracting them a second time elsewhere.
- 13 **Nora:** If the two hundred is released next month, should the sales report show another two hundred of sales?
- 14 **Felix:** No. A ⁵ _____ concerns existing funds. We would reconcile the later statement and its actual deductions rather than record a new sale.
- 15 **Nora:** Can I put the release in next month's cash forecast as certain? I would like to use that money for a supplier payment.
- 16 **Felix:** We have no release date here. Show any forecast assumption explicitly and check the applicable reserve terms before making a commitment against it.
- 17 **Nora:** I will keep captured sales, refunds, fees, and held funds in separate columns. The payout column will remain separate from confirmed bank receipts.
- 18 **Felix:** That gives us a usable ⁶ _____. Finance can then apply the appropriate accounting treatment without trying to reconstruct the statement from one net figure.
- 19 **Nora:** For today's trading call: four thousand one hundred issued, two hundred reserved, and bank receipt still outstanding. Not nine hundred in unexplained losses.
- 20 **Felix:** That is clear. Attach the statement reference and leave the receipt check assigned to me; the commercial team can use the sales measures without confusing them with cash.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. settlement statement | 2. processing fees | 3. reserve hold | 4. bank receipt | 5. reserve release | 6. reconciliation trail

Trace a smaller payout

F Say it in a new situation

Fictional statement: \$2,000 captured sales, \$150 refunds, \$100 fees, and \$80 reserved. No other adjustments. The payout is issued, but bank receipt is unconfirmed. Any later reserve release relates to these existing funds.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

sale / unconfirmed / 1,850 / 1,670

09

Manager: Sales less the refunds equal ¹ _____ dollars.

Analyst: After fees and the reserve, the issued payout is ² _____ dollars.

Manager: Bank receipt is still ³ _____.

Analyst: Releasing the reserve would not create a new ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. 1,850 | 2. 1,670 | 3. unconfirmed | 4. sale

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

The right shirt, the wrong variant

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Resolve a catalog mismatch by reading back identifiers and distinguishing variant data from product-group data.

Fictional Harbor Tee variants: blue/medium SKU HT-BL-M has zero available; blue/large SKU HT-BL-L has twenty. Both belong to group HARBOR-TEE. The large variant's shopping-feed title incorrectly says medium and its link preselects medium. Its size field and manufacturer-assigned GTIN are verified as large. No customer order has been placed.

PEOPLE / Sana: Catalog specialist | Joel: Digital merchandiser

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

item group ID / GTIN / landing-page selection / variant SKU / size attribute / processed feed

- 01 **Joel:** The shopping result says blue, medium, twenty available. Our medium shelf is empty. Is this another inventory-feed problem?
- 02 **Sana:** The twenty belongs to large. The ¹ _____ ends in L, and the size field says large. The title has been copied from medium.
- 03 **Joel:** Both rows use HARBOR-TEE as their group. Should I change the large row to a completely different group to separate them?
- 04 **Sana:** No. The shared ² _____ connects variants of the same shirt. Keep distinct item IDs and the correct size on each row.
- 05 **Joel:** Then the parent group is not a stock pool. Twenty large shirts cannot support a promise of twenty medium shirts.
- 06 **Sana:** Exactly. The ³ _____ is already correct for large. Fix the misleading title rather than changing that accurate field to match it.
- 07 **Joel:** The image shows the blue shirt. It would look the same in medium and large. That may be why the mistake survived the visual check.
- 08 **Sana:** Yes. An image can confirm color and style without proving size. Check the identifiers and supplied product data, not the thumbnail alone.
- 09 **Joel:** The link also opens medium by default. If we change only the title, the shopper could still land on the wrong selection.
- 10 **Sana:** We need the ⁴ _____ to match the large offer. Test the actual feed link, not just navigation from the main product page.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Joel:** The barcode field is verified as large. Should I copy medium's barcode so all the grouped rows share one?
- 12 **Sana:** No. Preserve the verified ⁵ _____. Sharing a product group does not make different trade-item identifiers interchangeable. Do not invent a replacement number either.
- 13 **Joel:** I will leave the correct stock, size, and identifier alone. The title and the link selection are the two confirmed corrections.
- 14 **Sana:** Right. Then preview both variants separately. A fix for large should not change medium's zero availability or turn the group record into a purchasable extra item.
- 15 **Joel:** Can I tell the trading team the listing is fixed as soon as I save the source file?
- 16 **Sana:** Not yet. Check the ⁶ _____ and the displayed offer after ingestion. Record any delay or rejection instead of assuming the update has propagated.
- 17 **Joel:** I will test the large shopping result through to the selected large item and confirm the stock still shows twenty.
- 18 **Sana:** And test medium separately: correct medium title, medium selection, and zero availability. That second check catches accidental changes to the sibling variant.
- 19 **Joel:** My handoff will list both SKUs, their size and stock, the corrected title and link, and the destination check. No inventory adjustment is needed from these facts.
- 20 **Sana:** Good. We are repairing the offer mapping, not manufacturing stock or changing the shirt. That is the distinction the support team needs when answering the next query.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. variant SKU | 2. item group ID | 3. size attribute | 4. landing-page selection | 5. GTIN | 6. processed feed

Read the variant, not just the group

F Say it in a new situation

Fictional red cap: medium SKU RC-M has 0 available; large SKU RC-L has 12. Both share group RED-CAP. The large feed row wrongly says medium in its title; its size field and verified GTIN correctly identify large.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

0 / RC-L / RED-CAP / GTIN

10

Merchandise: The twelve available units belong to SKU ¹ _____.

Specialist: The shared group identifier is ² _____.

Merchandise: Medium's available quantity remains ³ _____.

Specialist: Correct the large row's title, not its already verified ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. RC-L | 2. RED-CAP | 3. 0 | 4. GTIN

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Two discounts, two calculation bases

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Explain an offer using its actual combination order and eligibility threshold, then agree precise customer-facing wording.

Fictional tested offer: a \$100 product gets a 20% product discount, followed by a combinable 10% order discount on the reduced merchandise subtotal. Free shipping requires at least \$75 AFTER both discounts; otherwise shipping is \$5. No tax or other charge. These rules are supplied for this offer, not every platform or combination.

PEOPLE / Emil: Promotions executive | Grace: Trading quality analyst

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

product discount / checkout summary / merchandise subtotal / combination eligibility / shipping threshold / order discount

11

- 01 **Emil:** The banner says thirty percent off with free shipping. We have twenty percent off the product and another ten percent at checkout. Does that wording work?
- 02 **Grace:** Not for this setup. The ¹ _____ reduces the hundred-dollar item to eighty. The next ten percent uses eighty as its base.
- 03 **Emil:** So the checkout discount is eight dollars, not another ten. That leaves seventy-two for the merchandise.
- 04 **Grace:** Yes. This ² _____ follows the product discount. The combined merchandise saving is twenty-eight dollars, or twenty-eight percent of the original price.
- 05 **Emil:** I added the percentages because both messages used percent off. The different bases are what make that calculation wrong here.
- 06 **Grace:** Exactly. We should say twenty percent off the product, then an extra ten percent off the reduced subtotal. Show the final example price as well.
- 07 **Emil:** What about free shipping? The original price is a hundred, and even the first discounted amount is eighty. Both are above seventy-five.
- 08 **Grace:** The ³ _____ is checked after both discounts. Seventy-two falls below seventy-five, so the five-dollar shipping charge applies.
- 09 **Emil:** That makes the payable total seventy-seven, with no tax or other charge in this test. It is not seventy dollars delivered.
- 10 **Grace:** Correct. The ⁴ _____ and final total need separate labels. A shipping charge is not a reversal of the product discount.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Emil:** Can we increase the free-shipping threshold calculation to the pre-discount price instead? That would make the banner easier to keep.
- 12 **Grace:** That would be a different commercial rule requiring an approved change and retest. Do not change the interpretation simply to rescue wording already drafted.
- 13 **Emil:** Fair. I will correct the banner to match the approved offer. We can show the free-shipping condition beside it rather than imply everyone qualifies.
- 14 **Grace:** Also confirm ⁵ _____ in the actual checkout. An entered code is not proof that its discount applied successfully.
- 15 **Emil:** Should our support script say percentages always apply one after another? That would be a quick explanation for agents.
- 16 **Grace:** No. Other classes and configurations can use the same base or disallow combining. Explain this product-then-order sequence without turning it into a universal rule.
- 17 **Emil:** For the test record, I will capture the starting hundred, twenty off, eight off, seventy-two subtotal, five shipping, and seventy-seven total.
- 18 **Grace:** Include the ⁶ _____ and the approved conditions. Test a qualifying basket separately instead of assuming this below-threshold basket covers both outcomes.
- 19 **Emil:** Then the revised message can give the seventy-two merchandise price and state that this basket has five-dollar shipping. No thirty-percent or free-shipping claim for it.
- 20 **Grace:** That works. Send the corrected copy and the captured calculation together so merchandising, support, and the checkout team all explain the same offer.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. product discount | 2. order discount | 3. shipping threshold | 4. merchandise subtotal | 5. combination eligibility | 6. checkout summary

Check the threshold after both reductions

F Say it in a new situation

Fictional offer: \$200 product, 25% product discount, then 10% order discount on the reduced subtotal. Free shipping starts at \$140 AFTER both discounts; otherwise \$6. No tax or other charges.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

below / 135 / 141 / 150

11

Executive: After the product discount, the subtotal is ¹ _____ dollars.

Analyst: After the order discount, merchandise costs ² _____ dollars.

Executive: Shipping is charged because that subtotal is ³ _____ the threshold.

Analyst: Including shipping, the total is ⁴ _____ dollars.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. 150 | 2. 135 | 3. below | 4. 141

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Merchandising and Assortment Planning

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What is Range A's sell-through under the stated definition?

D. 80%

Eighty units sold divided by one hundred opening units equals eighty percent.

2. How many units remain in Range B?

A. 80

Two hundred opening units minus one hundred twenty sold leaves eighty units.

3. What is not yet established?

C. Which range has higher gross profit

Product costs are missing, so equal revenue does not establish relative gross profit.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which comparison is accurate?

A. A sold 80% of opening units; B sold 60%.

Each range needs its own opening-unit denominator; revenue does not replace that stock base.

2. Which claim needs product costs?

B. A earned more gross profit than B.

Gross profit subtracts product costs, which the briefing does not supply.

3. Which recommendation is appropriately limited?

C. Review B by variant and customer segment before changing the buy.

Variant and segment evidence supports a more specific decision than the aggregate result alone.

4. Which wording states a condition?

B. We can revise the buy once the cost and variant review is complete.

Once makes the proposed action depend on completing the specified review.

01 Conversation answers

Merchandising and Assortment Planning

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. sell-through. Turn 2. Sell-through compares sold units with the defined stock base, revealing a difference that equal revenue hides.

2. residual stock. Turn 4. Residual stock is the inventory left after sales; B retains eighty units while A retains twenty.

3. markdown. Turn 6. Markdown names the price reduction used to support B's sales, not the sales volume itself.

4. delisting. Turn 8. Delisting removes a product from the active range; the evidence does not yet justify removing all of B.

5. size curve. Turn 10. The size curve describes the unit distribution across sizes, which may explain uneven leftover stock.

6. customer segment. Turn 12. Customer segment identifies the group served by a range and helps assess its distinct commercial role.

7. buying budget. Turn 14. Buying budget names the money allocated to merchandise purchases, constraining the proposed initial order.

8. gross margin return on inventory. Turn 16. This measure relates gross profit to average inventory cost, requiring cost and investment information absent here.

9. range review. Turn 18. Range review is the structured assessment bringing together sales, stock, pricing, and the role of the selection.

10. assortment depth. Turn 20. Assortment depth concerns the variety of options within a line, such as sizes and colorways; units held per option are stock depth.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. 75%

Buyer: "C has a sell-through rate of 75%."

Forty-five sold units divided by sixty opening units equals seventy-five percent.

2. 50%

Planner: "D has a sell-through rate of 50%."

Sixty sold units divided by one hundred twenty opening units equals fifty percent.

3. 15

Buyer: "C has 15 units remaining."

Sixty opening units less forty-five sold leaves fifteen remaining units.

4. 60

Planner: "D has 60 units remaining."

One hundred twenty opening units less sixty sold leaves sixty remaining units.

02 Briefing and language checks

Pricing, Promotions, and Margin

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What was promotion revenue?

A. \$5,100

One hundred twenty units multiplied by forty-two dollars fifty equals five thousand one hundred dollars.

2. What was promotion gross profit on the stated basis?

C. \$1,500

Revenue of \$5,100 less product costs of \$3,600 leaves \$1,500 gross profit.

3. Which cost is excluded?

D. Operating expenses

The brief includes unit product cost but explicitly excludes operating expenses.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which statement correctly combines the price and volume effects?

C. Revenue rose 2%.

The new quantity factor 1.20 multiplied by price factor 0.85 gives revenue factor 1.02.

2. What happened to gross profit?

D. It fell from \$2,000 to \$1,500.

Baseline gross profit is 100 times \$20; promotion gross profit is 120 times \$12.50.

3. How many promotional units would match baseline gross profit?

D. 160

The \$2,000 baseline divided by \$12.50 unit gross profit requires 160 units.

4. Which claim goes beyond the supplied evidence?

D. The campaign acquired profitable new customers.

No customer-acquisition or customer-profitability evidence is supplied by the weekly sales figures.

02 Conversation answers

Pricing, Promotions, and Margin

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. unit volume.** Turn 2. Unit volume counts units sold; the twenty-percent increase does not alone establish revenue or profit improvement.
- 2. Sales revenue.** Turn 4. Sales revenue is price multiplied by units here; it rose from five thousand to five thousand one hundred dollars.
- 3. cost of goods sold.** Turn 6. Cost of goods sold includes thirty dollars for each sold unit, rising as unit volume increases.
- 4. gross profit.** Turn 8. Gross profit subtracts product costs from revenue; the resulting amounts are two thousand and fifteen hundred dollars.
- 5. unit gross profit.** Turn 10. Unit gross profit subtracts the thirty-dollar product cost from each selling price, producing twenty dollars and twelve fifty.
- 6. break-even volume.** Turn 12. Break-even volume here is explicitly the quantity needed to match prior gross profit, not company-wide net-profit break-even.
- 7. baseline.** Turn 14. Baseline identifies the reference week against which this promotion is compared, not proof of wider customer benefits.
- 8. funding allowance.** Turn 16. Funding allowance is supplier support under agreed terms; an unconfirmed possibility must not be booked as an established benefit.
- 9. gross margin percentage.** Turn 18. Gross margin percentage divides gross profit by revenue; fifteen hundred over fifty-one hundred is approximately twenty-nine point four percent.
- 10. margin dilution.** Turn 20. Margin dilution names the reduction in the profit margin, allowing a balanced account alongside the higher sales volume.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. 4,000

Manager: "Baseline revenue was 4,000 dollars."

Fifty units multiplied by eighty dollars yields four thousand dollars of revenue.

2. 4,200

Analyst: "Promotion revenue was 4,200 dollars."

Sixty units multiplied by seventy dollars yields four thousand two hundred dollars.

3. 1,500

Manager: "Baseline gross profit was 1,500 dollars."

Fifty units times the thirty-dollar unit gross profit gives fifteen hundred dollars.

4. 1,200

Analyst: "Promotion gross profit was 1,200 dollars."

Sixty units times the twenty-dollar unit gross profit gives twelve hundred dollars.

03 Briefing and language checks

Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. How many warehouse units are available for new sales?

A. 30

One hundred on-hand units less sixty committed and ten held leaves thirty available.

2. How many incoming units are included in the on-hand total?

D. None

The brief explicitly separates twenty incoming units from the one hundred physically on hand.

3. What is established for Store East?

B. It has no units.

Store East has zero units, so warehouse stock cannot establish local pickup readiness.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which website claim is supported now?

B. Store East has no stock for pickup.

The local store has no units; the warehouse total does not change that fact.

2. Which arithmetic matches warehouse availability?

C. 100 minus 60 minus 10 equals 30.

Both existing commitments and the quality hold must be removed from the on-hand total.

3. Which step requires a separate check?

B. Whether the warehouse can fulfill the customer's delivery route

The brief leaves delivery eligibility unconfirmed despite the warehouse having thirty available units.

4. Which wording overstates a proposed transfer?

B. The replenishment has arrived at Store East.

A proposed stock movement does not establish physical receipt at the receiving store.

03 Conversation answers

Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

1. inventory snapshot. Turn 2. Inventory snapshot fixes the quantity and status at a particular time; these records describe the position at nine.

2. on-hand inventory. Turn 4. On-hand inventory includes all physically held units in this case, including commitments and units on quality hold.

3. incoming inventory. Turn 6. Incoming inventory is expected stock not yet received; it must not be counted as already held at this warehouse.

4. quality hold. Turn 8. Quality hold restricts the ten units pending review; commercial demand does not itself authorize their release.

5. committed inventory. Turn 10. Committed inventory is allocated to existing demand and cannot be treated as unassigned stock for another sale.

6. fulfillment eligibility. Turn 12. Fulfillment eligibility establishes whether this item and warehouse may serve the proposed order and delivery route.

7. stock reservation. Turn 14. Stock reservation assigns stock to a particular demand; a general available balance does not establish that assignment.

8. inventory feed. Turn 16. Inventory feed supplies stock information to the website; its location and state mapping must support the displayed promise.

9. transfer order. Turn 18. Transfer order records an authorized inter-location movement; it does not prove the receiving store already has the goods.

10. location-level availability. Turn 20. Location-level availability ties sellable quantities to a specific site, preventing warehouse inventory from implying local pickup readiness.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. 30

Trader: "The available warehouse quantity is 30."

Eighty on hand minus forty-five committed and five held leaves thirty available.

2. five

Controller: "The held quantity is five."

The briefing explicitly identifies five units as held rather than available for sale.

3. twelve

Trader: "The incoming quantity is twelve."

Twelve units are expected separately and are not part of on-hand stock.

4. zero

Controller: "Store South's current quantity is zero."

The warehouse quantities do not change Store South's explicitly stated zero stock.

04 Briefing and language checks

Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What is confirmed?

A. The carrier physically received the order on 4 May.

Physical handoff on 4 May is established; delivery and remedies remain unconfirmed.

2. What does 14:00 today represent?

C. A status update

The agent promises a communication update, not any unconfirmed shipment or financial outcome.

3. What is unknown?

D. The revised arrival time

The carrier has not confirmed a new arrival time in the supplied record.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which response is both honest and useful?

A. The carrier has no confirmed new arrival; I will investigate and update you at 14:00.

The supported response combines the real uncertainty with an action and a communication commitment.

2. Which event proves shipment in this case?

D. Physical carrier handoff on 4 May

The briefing establishes actual carrier possession, not merely preparation or an estimated future event.

3. Which promise is not supported?

A. A replacement will arrive tomorrow.

Neither replacement authorization nor a replacement arrival date is supplied.

4. What should a pending-carrier update do?

D. State that the reply is pending and identify the continuing action.

An honest update preserves the commitment without fabricating an answer or excluding applicable rights.

04 Conversation answers

Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. estimated delivery date.** Turn 2. Estimated delivery date names the projected arrival that has passed; it is not proof that delivery occurred.
- 2. carrier handoff.** Turn 4. Carrier handoff means the parcel was physically transferred to the transport provider, which is established for 4 May.
- 3. delivery window.** Turn 6. Delivery window identifies an expected or scheduled arrival interval; no revised interval is confirmed here.
- 4. carrier inquiry.** Turn 8. Carrier inquiry is the concrete request for shipment investigation that the agent is authorized to initiate.
- 5. tracking event.** Turn 10. Tracking event is a recorded shipment milestone; checking it supports an update without guaranteeing a future arrival.
- 6. replacement order.** Turn 12. Replacement order supplies another item, but this record contains no authorization for the agent to promise one.
- 7. refund authorization.** Turn 14. Refund authorization is approval for returning payment; the agent must not imply an approval that the record lacks.
- 8. delivery exception.** Turn 16. Delivery exception identifies an interruption to the expected process; it requires investigation rather than an invented lost-parcel finding.
- 9. service recovery.** Turn 18. Service recovery concerns addressing the customer experience after the delay, including accountable follow-up and checking available remedies.
- 10. dispatch.** Turn 20. Dispatch concerns sending the goods; it must remain separate from the still-unconfirmed arrival at the customer's address.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. 12 June

Agent: "Carrier handoff occurred on 12 June."

Twelve June is the confirmed physical handoff date, not the estimated arrival.

2. 14 June

Customer: "The original estimated arrival was 14 June."

Fourteen June is the supplied estimate that has already passed.

3. unconfirmed

Agent: "The revised arrival time remains unconfirmed."

No new arrival time is established by the facts in this exchange.

4. 16:00

Customer: "The next status update is at 16:00."

Sixteen hundred is the contact commitment and must not become a delivery guarantee.

05 Briefing and language checks

Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What is the later conversion rate?

D. 32%

Three hundred twenty completed purchasing sessions divided by one thousand eligible sessions equals thirty-two percent.

2. What is the absolute rate decline?

D. Eight percentage points

Forty percent minus thirty-two percent is eight percentage points.

3. Which causal conclusion is established?

D. The cause is not isolated by this before-and-after comparison.

The outage and unverified comparability prevent this comparison from isolating one cause.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which sentence uses the correct units?

D. Conversion fell eight percentage points, a twenty-percent relative decline.

The absolute difference is eight points; eight divided by the original forty is twenty percent.

2. Which denominator belongs in this report?

D. Eligible checkout sessions

The briefing explicitly defines conversion using the eligible checkout-session base.

3. Which statement overclaims causality?

A. The redesign caused the entire decline.

A concurrent outage and unverified comparability leave the redesign's isolated effect unresolved.

4. Which diagnostic is useful but not automatically causal proof?

B. Compare outage-affected intervals with unaffected intervals while checking their differences.

Segment comparisons can reveal patterns, but differing populations or timing may still complicate causality.

05 Conversation answers

Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. checkout conversion. Turn 2. Checkout conversion uses completed purchasing sessions over eligible checkout sessions, giving forty percent before and thirty-two percent after.

2. percentage points. Turn 4. Percentage points express the absolute difference between the forty-percent and thirty-two-percent rates.

3. denominator. Turn 6. Denominator is the rate's base; equal base counts do not guarantee equal populations, conditions, or measurement.

4. provider outage. Turn 8. Provider outage names the concurrent service disruption that complicates attributing the whole decline to the redesign.

5. traffic mix. Turn 10. Traffic mix describes the composition of sessions; differences between intervals can complicate interpreting their conversion rates.

6. event instrumentation. Turn 12. Event instrumentation is the collection implementation; a change can alter what is recorded even when behavior is unchanged.

7. deduplication. Turn 14. Deduplication handles repeated records; the session-based definition also requires counting each purchasing session at most once.

8. device segment. Turn 16. Device segment groups sessions by device type, allowing the team to locate patterns hidden by the aggregate rate.

9. rollback. Turn 18. Rollback returns to an earlier version; deciding on it requires the relevant operational risks and evidence, not a fabricated causal certainty.

10. causal attribution. Turn 20. Causal attribution assigns an outcome to a cause; this comparison supports an observed decline but not an isolated redesign effect.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. 50%

Lead: "The original rate was 50%."

Three hundred purchasing sessions divided by six hundred eligible sessions equals fifty percent.

2. 40%

Analyst: "The later rate was 40%."

Two hundred forty purchasing sessions divided by six hundred eligible sessions equals forty percent.

3. ten percentage points

Lead: "The absolute decline was ten percentage points."

Fifty percent minus forty percent is an absolute ten-percentage-point difference.

4. 20%

Analyst: "The relative decline was 20%."

Ten percentage points divided by the original fifty-percent rate equals a twenty-percent relative decline.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Marketplace and Vendor Management

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What is Vendor K's defective-unit rate?

D. 1.25%

Ten defective units divided by eight hundred received units equals one point two five percent.

2. What is Vendor M's defective-unit rate?

C. 2.5%

Five defective units divided by two hundred received units equals two point five percent.

3. What remains unverified?

D. Comparable product mix and inspection intensity

The brief explicitly leaves product mix and inspection intensity unconfirmed as comparable.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which ranking is arithmetically correct?

D. K has a lower defective-unit rate than M.

K's 1.25% rate is below M's 2.5% rate on the stated received-unit bases.

2. If one unit has three faults, how is it counted here?

C. As one defective unit

The case explicitly counts each defective unit once regardless of its number of faults.

3. Which claim still needs investigation?

A. K has better inherent quality under comparable conditions.

Product mix and inspection intensity may differ, so inherent comparative quality is not established.

4. Which action is not authorized merely by the scorecard?

B. Deducting a chargeback from the supplier's invoice

Commercial deductions require their applicable terms and basis, not just a performance label.

06 Conversation answers

Marketplace and Vendor Management

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

1. received units. Turn 2. Received units supply the stated rate denominator; ten and five alone are counts rather than rates.

2. defective-unit rate. Turn 4. Defective-unit rate divides defective units by received units here, yielding 1.25 percent for K and 2.5 percent for M.

3. reporting period. Turn 6. Reporting period fixes both numerator and denominator to July receipts so the comparison does not mix intervals.

4. defect count. Turn 8. Defect count counts individual faults; several faults on one unit must not become several defective units in this metric.

5. product mix. Turn 10. Product mix describes the goods included; different products can limit a claim about inherent comparative supplier quality.

6. inspection record. Turn 12. Inspection record supplies traceable findings and examination details needed to investigate the reported defective units.

7. root cause. Turn 14. Root cause is the supported underlying reason; the conversation supplies only an unconfirmed packaging hypothesis.

8. chargeback. Turn 16. Chargeback is a commercial deduction or charge whose basis must follow the applicable agreement, not the scorecard alone.

9. remediation plan. Turn 18. Remediation plan sets out actions addressing the problem once the evidence supports what needs to change.

10. vendor scorecard. Turn 20. Vendor scorecard should present defined measures accurately while leaving unresolved cause and commercial questions visible.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. 1%

Manager: "P's defective-unit rate is 1%."

Six divided by six hundred equals one percent on the specified received-unit basis.

2. 2%

Supplier: "Q's defective-unit rate is 2%."

Four divided by two hundred equals two percent on the specified received-unit basis.

3. P

Manager: "The larger defective-unit count belongs to P."

P has six defective units compared with Q's four, so its count is larger.

4. Q

Supplier: "The higher defective-unit rate belongs to Q."

Q's two-percent rate exceeds P's one-percent rate despite Q's smaller defective-unit count.

07 Briefing and language checks

Customer Service and Escalations

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. Why does Owen want to return the jacket?

B. He changed his mind.

The briefing specifies a change of mind and supplies no fault or misdescription allegation.

2. What can Elena authorize herself?

C. Submission of a manager review, not approval of the exception

Elena can submit the request but does not hold the stated exception-approval authority.

3. How should the 30-day policy be treated?

D. As a stated policy that does not override applicable rights

The policy informs the request, but actual customer rights and transaction facts still require checking.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which sentence stays within Elena's authority?

B. I can submit a manager review, but I cannot guarantee its outcome.

Elena can submit the request but cannot approve or promise the review result.

2. Which record best matches the stated request?

C. Change of mind; unworn jacket; day 35; \$80 purchase

The correct record preserves the actual reason, condition, timing, and amount without inventing an outcome.

3. Which response to a newly alleged fault is appropriate?

B. Record the allegation and assess the applicable rights and process separately.

A fault allegation raises a different assessment and cannot be decided merely from this change-of-mind policy.

4. Which phrase asks permission without implying approval?

C. Would you like me to submit the review?

The question offers a specific submission action while leaving the review decision unmade.

07 Conversation answers

Customer Service and Escalations

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. change-of-mind return. Turn 2. Change-of-mind return accurately identifies Owen's stated reason, rather than inventing a fault or misdescription.

2. return window. Turn 4. Return window is the retailer's stated thirty-day period for this purchase, not a universal legal limit.

3. goodwill exception. Turn 6. Goodwill exception is a permitted discretionary departure from policy; requesting it does not establish approval or replace applicable rights.

4. manager review. Turn 8. Manager review is the assessment step Elena can submit; its result is not supplied or guaranteed.

5. store credit. Turn 10. Store credit is value for a future purchase; it also requires an actual available or approved basis here.

6. proof of purchase. Turn 12. Proof of purchase identifies the transaction and its details, supporting the review without requiring a fabricated outcome.

7. exception authority. Turn 14. Exception authority identifies who may approve a policy departure; Elena's submission does not transfer that decision power to her.

8. fault allegation. Turn 16. Fault allegation is a reported defect requiring its own assessment; it must not be automatically rejected under the goodwill window.

9. complaint record. Turn 18. Complaint record preserves the customer's actual concern, supplied details, and handling without turning a request into an approved remedy.

10. service handoff. Turn 20. Service handoff transfers accurate context and responsibility, including the distinction between a submitted review and its eventual outcome.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. 22

Noor: "The request is on day 22."

Twenty-two is the request day stated for this separate transaction.

2. 14

Customer: "The stated policy window is 14 days."

Fourteen days is the fictional policy period, not an invented universal legal rule.

3. Beth

Noor: "The manager reviewing the request is Beth."

Beth is the named manager; Noor only submits the review.

4. approval

Customer: "Submission does not guarantee approval."

A submitted review is not the same as an approved exception or remedy.

08 Briefing and language checks

Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. Which item has not been located?

A. The mug

The briefing identifies the mug as missing while the other two items are staged.

2. What does the local whole-order ready status require?

B. Every ordered item verified and staged

The local rule requires all ordered items, not just part of the order, to be verified and staged.

3. Who owns the next customer contact?

B. Evan

Evan is the incoming lead assigned to contact the customer and update the case.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which handoff is actionable?

D. P64: two items staged, mug missing, ready status incorrect; Evan contacts customer and updates at 16:30.

The detailed handoff preserves physical facts, the system mismatch, responsibility, and the next checkpoint.

2. Which substitution claim is supported?

C. No substitute has been approved.

The briefing explicitly leaves substitution unapproved and does not supply customer consent.

3. What does 16:30 mean?

B. A case-update checkpoint

Sixteen thirty is the scheduled update, not proof of any particular resolution outcome.

4. Which record would invent an event?

A. Marking the missing mug as collected because staff cannot find it

Failure to locate an item is not evidence that the customer collected it.

08 Conversation answers

Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. order-level status.** Turn 2. Order-level status describes the whole order; ready is unsupported when one of the three required items is missing.
- 2. staging.** Turn 4. Staging places the picked items in the holding area; it confirms preparation of two items, not completion of all three.
- 3. pickup notification.** Turn 6. Pickup notification communicates collection readiness; an inaccurate ready message needs correction and direct customer follow-up.
- 4. partial pickup.** Turn 8. Partial pickup supplies only part of the order and needs the permitted process plus the customer's agreement here.
- 5. substitution.** Turn 10. Substitution provides a different item; the nearby mug cannot replace the ordered one without the necessary approval and agreement.
- 6. short pick.** Turn 12. Short pick identifies the unfulfilled picking quantity, keeping the missing mug visible instead of treating the order as complete.
- 7. action owner.** Turn 14. Action owner identifies Evan as responsible for the next customer contact, preventing the task from being lost between shifts.
- 8. refund status.** Turn 16. Refund status records the actual payment-return stage; a cancellation request or missing item does not itself establish a completed refund.
- 9. discrepancy log.** Turn 18. Discrepancy log preserves the mismatch between physical items and system status, together with ownership and follow-up information.
- 10. resolution checkpoint.** Turn 20. Resolution checkpoint is the scheduled progress review at sixteen thirty, not an automatic completion or refund event.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. C17

Outgoing lead: "The order reference is C17."

C17 identifies the particular pickup order that needs the handoff.

2. desk lamp

Jun: "The missing item is the desk lamp."

The desk lamp is the unstaged item, not one of the three already prepared.

3. Jun

Outgoing lead: "The next contact owner is Jun."

Jun is explicitly assigned responsibility for contacting the customer after the handoff.

4. 18:00

Jun: "The next case update is at 18:00."

Eighteen hundred is the update checkpoint, not a guaranteed completion time.

08

09 Conversation answers

Sales are not the bank payout

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. settlement statement. Turn 2. The settlement statement connects the captured sales to refunds, fees, reserved funds, and the issued payout; the difference is not automatically missing money.

2. processing fees. Turn 4. The processing fees are the stated \$300 deduction; unlike the reserve, they are nonrefundable under this fictional statement's terms.

3. reserve hold. Turn 6. The reserve hold sets aside \$200 rather than paying it out now; it is distinct from the nonrefundable \$300 fee and has no supplied release date.

4. bank receipt. Turn 10. Bank receipt confirms the funds actually reached the bank; an issued marketplace payout is a different processing stage and is not sufficient evidence of receipt.

5. reserve release. Turn 14. A reserve release makes previously held funds available; it does not create a new customer sale, and any later deductions still need reconciliation.

6. reconciliation trail. Turn 18. A reconciliation trail preserves how each adjustment connects the source statement to the payout and bank record, making later differences traceable.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. 1,850

Manager: Sales less the refunds equal 1,850 dollars.

Two thousand captured sales less one hundred fifty refunded leaves one thousand eight hundred fifty.

2. 1,670

Analyst: After fees and the reserve, the issued payout is 1,670 dollars.

Subtracting the one-hundred-dollar fee and eighty-dollar reserve from 1,850 gives 1,670.

3. unconfirmed

Manager: Bank receipt is still unconfirmed.

The statement establishes issuance only; no bank record of receipt has been supplied.

4. sale

Analyst: Releasing the reserve would not create a new sale.

The reserve contains existing transaction funds, so its later release is not another customer purchase.

Background reading: [Shopify: payment reserves and releases](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

10 Conversation answers

The right shirt, the wrong variant

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

1. variant SKU. Turn 2. The variant SKU identifies the specific internal item: HT-BL-L is blue/large, while HT-BL-M is blue/medium with no available units.

2. item group ID. Turn 4. The item group ID groups genuine variants of the same product; it does not replace each variant's distinct identifier or merge their stock quantities.

3. size attribute. Turn 6. The size attribute must describe the offered variant; here large is correct and medium in the title is the mismatch needing correction.

4. landing-page selection. Turn 10. The landing-page selection must correspond to the advertised variant; a large listing linked to a preselected medium option still creates a mismatch.

5. GTIN. Turn 12. The Global Trade Item Number is a product identifier assigned under the applicable system; the verified large-variant GTIN must not be replaced with medium's merely to make grouped rows match.

6. processed feed. Turn 16. The processed feed shows what the destination accepted after ingestion; saving the source file alone does not establish the final displayed offer.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

1. RC-L

Merchandiser: The twelve available units belong to SKU RC-L.

The supplied inventory assigns all twelve units to the large variant, identified internally as RC-L.

2. RED-CAP

Specialist: The shared group identifier is RED-CAP.

Both genuine variants belong to RED-CAP, while retaining their own distinct item identities.

3. 0

Merchandiser: Medium's available quantity remains 0.

Correcting a title does not move or create stock for the medium variant.

4. GTIN

Specialist: Correct the large row's title, not its already verified GTIN.

The case verifies the large identifier, so changing it merely to match an erroneous title would introduce another error.

10

Background reading: [Google Merchant Center: grouping product variants](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

11 Conversation answers

Two discounts, two calculation bases

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

- 1. product discount.** Turn 2. The product discount takes twenty percent from the original \$100 product price, leaving \$80 before the order discount is calculated.
- 2. order discount.** Turn 4. The order discount is ten percent of the already reduced \$80 merchandise subtotal, so it removes \$8 under the supplied combination rules.
- 3. shipping threshold.** Turn 8. The shipping threshold is assessed after both discounts in this fictional offer; the relevant subtotal is \$72, below the \$75 minimum.
- 4. merchandise subtotal.** Turn 10. The merchandise subtotal is \$72 after both discounts, while the final payable total is \$77 after adding the separate \$5 shipping charge.
- 5. combination eligibility.** Turn 14. Combination eligibility determines whether the two offers may apply together; the supplied test allows this combination, but that does not establish other discount pairings.
- 6. checkout summary.** Turn 18. The checkout summary records the applied discounts, shipping basis, and payable total; it allows the displayed offer to be checked against the actual calculation.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

- 1. 150**
Executive: After the product discount, the subtotal is 150 dollars.
Twenty-five percent off two hundred removes fifty dollars, leaving one hundred fifty.
- 2. 135**
Analyst: After the order discount, merchandise costs 135 dollars.
Ten percent of the reduced one-hundred-fifty subtotal is fifteen, leaving one hundred thirty-five.
- 3. below**
Executive: Shipping is charged because that subtotal is below the threshold.
The post-discount subtotal of 135 is below the stated 140-dollar free-shipping threshold.
- 4. 141**
Analyst: Including shipping, the total is 141 dollars.
The one-hundred-thirty-five merchandise subtotal plus six-dollar shipping equals one hundred forty-one.

11

Background reading: [Shopify: discount classes and combination rules](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Merchandising and Assortment Planning

Open the comparison: Both ranges generated \$12,000 in the same four weeks.

State the remaining exposure: Range B still has eighty units on hand.

Ask for the missing basis: Can we add product costs before comparing gross profit?

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Pricing, Promotions, and Margin

Acknowledge volume: The promotion sold twenty percent more units.

Keep the cost basis: Product cost stayed at thirty dollars per unit.

Name the exclusion: This calculation excludes operating and promotional expenses.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Inventory, Allocation, and Replenishment

Identify the item: We are checking SKU L42.

Protect existing orders: Sixty units are already committed.

Correct the promise: The warehouse total must not drive a ready-for-pickup message here.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Fulfillment, Shipping, and Returns

Acknowledge the missed estimate: The estimated date has passed, and you still do not have the order.

Avoid an unsupported date: I do not have a confirmed revised arrival time.

Check the latest event: I will confirm what the tracking record actually shows.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Conversion, UX, and Digital Analytics

State the observed result: Checkout conversion fell from forty to thirty-two percent.

Define the counted outcome: We count a session once if it completes a purchase.

Request a measurement check: Has event collection remained consistent across the release?

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Marketplace and Vendor Management

Ask for the base: What received-unit denominator is behind this rate?

Correct the label: Ten is a count, not a percentage.

Check comparability: Were product mix and inspection intensity comparable?

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Customer Service and Escalations

Acknowledge the request: You would like to return the unworn jacket because you changed your mind.

Keep rights separate: We also need to check the rights applicable to the actual transaction.

Request relevant evidence: Please provide the purchase details through our approved process.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Store Operations and Omnichannel Execution

Start with the order: This handoff concerns pickup order P64.

Identify the contradiction: The website says ready, but the order is incomplete.

Reject an assumed substitute: No substitute has been approved.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

acceptance criterion confirm the acceptance criterion	51
action owner name the action owner	69
allocation revise the allocation	23
applicable rights check applicable rights	60
assortment review the assortment	5
assortment breadth broaden the assortment	5
assortment depth adjust assortment depth	5
available inventory confirm available inventory	23
available to promise calculate available to promise	23
average order value monitor average order value	15
backorder manage a backorder	24
baseline establish a baseline	14
basket value increase basket value	15
break-even volume calculate break-even volume	15
buy online, pick up in store (BOPIS) fulfill a BOPIS order	68
buying budget protect the buying budget	6
cancellation line confirm a cancellation line	69
cannibalization assess cannibalization	15
carrier handoff verify carrier handoff	32
carrier inquiry open a carrier inquiry	32
case owner identify the case owner	60
catalog attribute correct a catalog attribute	51
causal attribution qualify causal attribution	42
change-of-mind return handle a change-of-mind return	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

channel allocation review channel allocation	24
chargeback dispute a vendor chargeback	50
checkout abandonment investigate checkout abandonment	41
checkout conversion measure checkout conversion	41
click and collect manage click-and-collect orders	68
cohort define a cohort	42
collection verification complete collection verification	69
colorway add a colorway	6
committed inventory protect committed inventory	23
complaint record maintain a complaint record	60
confounder identify a confounder	42
consignment identify the consignment	32
content compliance review content compliance	51
contribution margin define contribution margin	14
controlled experiment run a controlled experiment	42
conversion funnel examine the conversion funnel	41
core line replenish a core line	6
cost of goods sold deduct cost of goods sold	14
customer consent obtain customer consent	69
customer segment serve a customer segment	6
cycle count perform a cycle count	24
deduplication validate deduplication	41
defect count distinguish the defect count	50
defective-unit rate calculate the defective-unit rate	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

delist propose a delisting	6
delivery attempt verify a delivery attempt	33
delivery exception investigate a delivery exception	32
delivery window confirm the delivery window	32
denominator keep the denominator consistent	41
device segment analyze a device segment	42
discount depth compare discount depth	15
discrepancy log update the discrepancy log	69
dispatch confirm dispatch	32
dispute evidence submit dispute evidence	51
duplicate event remove duplicate events	41
eligible session define eligible sessions	41
escalation route offer an escalation route	60
estimated delivery date revise an estimated delivery date	32
event instrumentation audit event instrumentation	41
exception authority confirm exception authority	59
exchange authorize an exchange	59
fault allegation record a fault allegation	60
friction reduce checkout friction	42
fulfillment track order fulfillment	32
fulfillment eligibility check fulfillment eligibility	24
full-price sale protect full-price sales	5
funding allowance verify a funding allowance	15
goodwill exception request a goodwill exception	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

gross margin percentage	calculate gross margin percentage	14
gross margin return on inventory	evaluate inventory return	6
gross profit	protect gross profit	14
halo effect	test for a halo effect	15
incoming inventory	track incoming inventory	23
incremental revenue	estimate incremental revenue	14
inspection intensity	compare inspection intensity	50
inspection record	retrieve the inspection record	51
inventory adjustment	authorize an inventory adjustment	24
inventory feed	correct the inventory feed	23
inventory snapshot	timestamp the inventory snapshot	24
item condition	assess item condition	59
item-level status	update item-level status	68
last mile	coordinate last-mile delivery	32
lead time	verify replenishment lead time	24
location-level availability	verify location-level availability	23
lot	trace the affected lot	51
manager review	submit a manager review	59
margin dilution	quantify margin dilution	15
markdown	take a markdown	5
marketplace listing	update the marketplace listing	51
misdescription	investigate misdescription	60
omnichannel	coordinate omnichannel execution	68
on-hand inventory	reconcile on-hand inventory	23

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

open-to-buy check open-to-buy	6
opening stock establish opening stock	5
option count review the option count	5
order management system (OMS) update the OMS	68
order-level status correct order-level status	69
original payment method verify the original payment method	59
overselling prevent overselling	24
partial fulfillment record partial fulfillment	33
partial pickup arrange partial pickup	69
payment failure investigate payment failures	42
payment gateway monitor the payment gateway	42
percentage point report a percentage-point change	41
pick list verify the pick list	68
picking complete order picking	68
pickup notification correct a pickup notification	69
pickup shelf check the pickup shelf	68
point of sale (POS) reconcile POS records	68
policy discretion explain policy discretion	60
price elasticity estimate price elasticity	15
price override approve a price override	15
price reduction apply a price reduction	14
product mix control for product mix	50
promotion mechanic explain the promotion mechanic	15
promotional uplift measure promotional uplift	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

proof of delivery	request proof of delivery	32
proof of purchase	verify proof of purchase	59
provider outage	isolate the provider outage	42
purchase channel	identify the purchase channel	59
purchase event	validate the purchase event	41
purchase order	reconcile the purchase order	50
quality hold	maintain a quality hold	23
random assignment	verify random assignment	42
range	compare product ranges	5
range rationalization	support range rationalization	6
range review	conduct a range review	6
ready-for-pickup status	correct ready-for-pickup status	68
reason code	select the correct reason code	60
received units	confirm received units	50
redemption rate	calculate redemption rate	15
refund	confirm a refund	59
refund authorization	confirm refund authorization	33
refund status	verify refund status	69
relative change	calculate relative change	41
remediation plan	agree a remediation plan	51
reorder point	set a reorder point	24
replacement order	authorize a replacement order	33
replenishment	schedule replenishment	23
reporting period	specify the reporting period	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

residual stock	reduce residual stock	5
resolution checkpoint	set a resolution checkpoint	69
resolution option	verify resolution options	60
restocking fee	explain a restocking fee	33
return authorization	issue a return authorization	33
return inspection	complete a return inspection	33
return to sender	investigate return to sender	33
return to vendor	authorize a return to vendor	51
return window	check the return window	59
reverse logistics	manage reverse logistics	33
review outcome	communicate the review outcome	60
rollback	evaluate a rollback	42
root cause	establish the root cause	50
safety stock	review safety stock	24
sales revenue	calculate sales revenue	14
sample size	state the sample size	51
seasonal line	exit a seasonal line	6
sell-through	calculate unit sell-through	5
seller of record	identify the seller of record	51
selling price	set the selling price	14
service handoff	complete a service handoff	60
service level	verify the service level	32
service recovery	coordinate service recovery	33
service-level agreement	review the service-level agreement	51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

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Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] Federal Trade Commission. Business Guide to the Mail, Internet, or Telephone Order Merchandise Rule.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on shipment promises and delay obligations. Shipment and delivery are distinguished; the fictional carrier-delay case is not a complete legal procedure. Checked 1 October 2026.

[2] Shopify Help Center. Understanding inventory states.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on on-hand, available, committed, unavailable, and incoming quantities. The fictional inventory case states its own quantities and location scope. Checked 1 October 2026.

[3] Google Analytics Help. About ecommerce metrics.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on event-level and item-level measures. The checkout case explicitly defines its own denominator rather than implying a universal platform conversion metric. Checked 1 October 2026.

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